

PENTHOUSE

Shooting Script & Scene Breakdown — bilingual (English / Telugu (Roman script))

A feature-length two-hander · single continuous film · 32 scenes · approx. 4 hr 33 min

Draft dated 6 October 2026

How to read each scene	Every scene opens with a header block (scene number, INT/EXT, location, story day/date and time, actors with costume number, approximate screen duration, props and furniture). The grid below runs beat by beat: action with its camera angle and lens on the left, dialogue in English with the Telugu line beneath it on the right. A shoot-instructions box closes each scene.
Cast on screen	Only RANI (35) and VIKRAM (25) appear on screen. Every other person is a voice on a phone (Ammamma, Vikram’s mother, Sravya, Kiran) or an off-screen presence. Crowds in Scene 1 stay out of focus.
Intimacy	All intimate moments are implied and cut away on a look, a light switch, a door or a match-cut. An intimacy coordinator is required on every bedroom scene; closed set, modesty garments throughout, no nudity. Customers are never seen.
Telugu address	Until Scene 25 Rani and Vikram use the respectful "meeru"; after the reveal they drop to "nuvvu". Telugu lines are written in Roman script (long vowels doubled: aa, ee, oo); English loanwords keep their English spelling.
Camera package (assumed)	Single camera, full-frame cinema body; prime set 24 / 35 / 50 / 85 mm and 100 mm macro; Steadicam and slider days as noted; drone for Scene 1 only. Lens and angle notes are a starting brief for the DOP.
Story calendar	Day 1 = Monday 9 June (arrival). The film ends at dawn on Day 119, Sunday 5 October. Dates are for continuity only and never appear on screen.

Costume plot

RANI

No.	Costume	Scenes
R1	Turmeric-yellow cotton saree, plain blouse, glass bangles, rubber chappals, cloth shoulder bag (arrival; returns for the final scene)	1, 2, 31, 32
R2	Faded green cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist for housework	6, 9, 12, 18
R3	Fresh sky-blue cotton saree, hair wet and loosely knotted	4, 5
R4	Maroon cotton saree, evening wear at home	7, 8, 10, 15, 20
R5	Soft grey cotton saree worn for sleep	3, 11, 14, 21
R6	Blue jeans (shop tag on, then removed) and sleeveless red top, barefoot, hair loose	12, 13
R7	Vikram's grey hoodie over a cotton nightie	16, 24
R8	Her best silk saree, peacock blue with zari border	18, 19
R9	Spa uniform: lilac tunic and trousers, name badge (drying on rail as set dressing)	21
R10	Montage wardrobe set: cotton kurti with jeans; floral knee-length dress; cotton shorts and T-shirt (bedroom only); rain-soaked chiffon saree; red nail polish	16
R11	Mustard cotton saree, hair braided by Vikram (lopsided)	16, 17
R12	Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas	22, 27
R13	Plum cotton saree, worn for the evening Leela call-in	23
R14	Faded orange cotton saree; after Scene 26 a grey towel wrap (modest	25, 26

	framing)	
R15	Black sheer georgette saree bought by Vikram, gold-tone necklace, heels, small evening purse	26
R16	Montage wardrobe set (dark phase): shawl over printed nightie; muted synthetic sarees; same black saree in variation	28
R17	Her late mother's red silk saree, jasmine garland, turmeric-yellow thread	29
R18	Printed chiffon saree with dupatta over her head, soaked through (wet doubles needed)	30

VIKRAM

No.	Costume	Scenes
V1	Black crew T-shirt, blue jeans, leather wrist band, sunglasses in hair, white sneakers	1, 2
V2	Grey vest and black track pants (night at home)	3, 8, 30
V3	White T-shirt, grey shorts, barefoot (mornings)	4, 5, 11, 14
V4	Printed casual shirt and chinos (evenings / event days)	6, 9, 10, 12, 13, 18
V5	Black hoodie and joggers	7, 15
V6	Montage wardrobe set: T-shirts, rain-soaked linen shirt, kurta for birthday night	16, 17
V7	White linen shirt sleeves rolled, dark jeans (celebration dinner)	19
V8	Bare back with towel draped over it, track pants (massage practice; modest framing)	20
V9	Navy T-shirt and track pants	21, 22, 23, 24, 28

V10	Towel at waist after shower, hair wet; later navy T-shirt	25
V11	Dark bomber jacket over black shirt, car keys (booking nights)	26, 27, 28
V12	Plain white cotton kurta and pyjama	29
V13	Same grey vest and track pants as V2, crumpled from a night on the floor	31, 32

Scene index

Sc.	Slug line	INT/EXT	Story day & time	Duration
1	EXT. MGBS BUS STATION / CITY ROADS — EARLY MORNING	EXT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 05:45–06:30 (first light)	~5 min
2	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — MORNING	INT / EXT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 06:45–07:30	~8 min
3	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — NIGHT	INT	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 23:30	~10 min
4	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NEXT MORNING	INT	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 08:00	~8 min
5	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE MORNING	EXT	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 11:00	~5 min
6	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — EVENING	INT	Day 4 · Thu 12 June · 18:30	~10 min
7	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 5 · Fri 13 June · 21:00	~5 min
8	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — NIGHT, RAIN	INT	Day 7 · Sun 15 June · 22:30	~12 min
9	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — DAY	INT	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 14:00	~8 min
10	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 21:00–23:30	~12 min
11	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NEXT MORNING	INT	Day 11 · Thu 19 June · 09:30	~4 min
12	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — AFTERNOON	INT	Day 13 · Sat 21 June · 15:00	~8 min
13	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 15 · Mon 23 June · 23:45 to dawn	~12 min
14	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — MORNING	INT	Day 16 · Tue 24 June · 07:30	~10 min
15	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE AFTERNOON	EXT	Day 17 · Wed 25 June · 17:00 to sunset	~6 min
16	MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — DAYS AND NIGHTS	INT / EXT	Days 18–26 · 26 June – 4 July · various; birthday night Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 22:00	~10 min
17	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 23:30	~5 min
18	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — DAY / EVENING	INT / EXT	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 09:00 (morning) and 18:30	~8 min

			(evening)	
19	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 21:00	~6 min
20	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 33 · Fri 11 July · 22:00	~10 min
21	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 52 · Wed 30 July · 23:00 (time-cut runs to Day 59)	~12 min
22	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — SUNDAY, RAIN ALL DAY	INT	Day 56 · Sun 3 August · 11:00–16:00 (rain all day)	~5 min
23	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT	INT	Day 63 · Sun 10 August · 23:30	~12 min
24	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN	EXT / INT	Day 64 · Mon 11 August · 05:45	~6 min
25	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT	INT	Day 67 · Thu 14 August · 23:20–23:50	~15 min
26	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / BATHROOM / HALL — SATURDAY NIGHT	INT / EXT	Day 69 · Sat 16 August · 19:30 → 02:50 → dawn 05:50	~12 min
27	INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — LATE MORNING	INT	Day 70 · Sun 17 August · 10:30	~5 min
28	MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — WEEKS	INT / EXT	Days 71–110 · 18 August – 26 September · various nights and afternoons	~10 min
29	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT	EXT	Day 112 · Sun 28 September · 21:30	~7 min
30	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT, RAIN	INT	Day 118 · Sat 4 October · 23:50 → 03:00 (storm, power cut)	~15 min
31	INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — BEFORE DAWN	INT	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 04:30	~6 min
32	EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN	EXT	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 06:00 (sunrise)	~6 min

= new romance scene added in this draft.

SCENE 1 EXT. MGBS BUS STATION / CITY ROADS — EARLY MORNING

Scene No.	1	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	MGBS Bus Station, Platform 14; bike ride via Tank Bund to Gachibowli	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 05:45–06:30 (first light)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree, plain blouse, glass bangles, rubber chappals, cloth shoulder bag VIKRAM — Costume V1: black crew T-shirt, blue jeans, leather wrist band, sunglasses pushed into hair, sneakers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Steel trunk (dented, village paint), cloth bag, Rani's basic keypad phone, Vikram's smartphone, Royal Enfield (black), bungee cord, helmet (Vikram only). Background: luggage and bus silhouettes kept soft-focus		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
1.1 Black screen. The hiss of an overnight bus braking. Then a phone ringing. CAMERA Black frame; sound design only. Phone ring pans L→R.	VIKRAM'S MOTHER (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Vikram, are you awake? Rani's bus reached. Platform 14. Don't keep her standing there like a parcel. And listen — she's a decent woman. Treat her like family. <i>Vikram, lechaavaa? Rani bassu vacchesindi. Platform padnaalugu. Parcel laagaa akkada nilabettaku. Inkaa vinu — tanu manchi manishi. Mana inti manishilaa choosuko.</i> VIKRAM (<i>O.S., sleepy</i>) Amma, I'm already on the bike. Bye. <i>Ammaa, already bike meede unnaa. Bye.</i>
1.2 FADE IN on a crowded platform, shot so that no other face is ever sharp: soft shapes, a blur of luggage. In the middle, in sharp focus, RANI (35) in a cotton saree the colour of turmeric, one steel trunk, one cloth bag. She grips the bag handle like it is the only thing she owns. She is not frightened. She is alert, the way people are when they have been hit before. CAMERA WIDE to MS, eye level, 85mm at T1.8 so the crowd melts. Slow 4-second push-in to her grip on the bag handle (insert, 100mm macro).	—

1.3 Her phone buzzes. Unknown number. She hesitates, then answers. CAMERA Insert on keypad phone screen (100mm). Back to MCU Rani, 85mm, slight low angle.	RANI Hello? <i>Hello?</i> VIKRAM (V.O.) Rani garu? Vikram. Look left. The black bike. The idiot waving. <i>Rani gaaroo? Vikramni. Edama vaipu choodandi. Nalla bike. Chetulooputunna aa picchodu.</i>
1.4 She turns. VIKRAM (25), sunglasses pushed up into his hair, black T-shirt, a leather band on his wrist, leaning on a Royal Enfield, waving with both arms like he is guiding a plane. She almost smiles, then stops herself. CAMERA Whip-pan with her look to LONG SHOT Vikram on the bike, 50mm. Return to CU Rani for the almost-smile, 85mm.	—
1.5 He jogs up and takes the trunk before she can protest. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm handheld, eye level, following his jog into frame.	VIKRAM You brought the whole house? <i>Illu mottam teccheshaaraa?</i> RANI Only what was mine. <i>Naadi anedi maatrame.</i>
1.6 He looks at her for a second longer than he means to. Then he laughs it off. CAMERA OTS from behind Rani onto Vikram, 85mm; hold the extra second before he laughs.	VIKRAM Then it's light. Come. <i>Ayite baruvem ledi. Randi.</i>
1.7 ON THE BIKE. The trunk is tied behind with a bungee cord. Rani sits sideways, saree pallu tucked tight, one hand on the grab rail, refusing to touch him. Hyderabad wakes around them: flyovers, the lake at Tank Bund, the glass towers of Gachibowli catching the first sun. Her eyes are wide. CAMERA Tracking vehicle: frontal two-shot, 35mm, low angle; profile tracking 50mm along Tank Bund; POV plates of the city, 24mm. CU Rani's eyes, 85mm, for wonder.	VIKRAM (shouting over the wind) First time in Hyderabad? <i>Hyderabad ide modatisaaraa?</i> RANI First time anywhere. <i>Ekkadikainaa ide modatisaari.</i>

1.8 A speed breaker. The bike jolts. Her hand flies off the rail and lands on his shoulder. She takes it back immediately, as if burned. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand landing on his shoulder and lifting off. Cut to MCU Vikram reacting in the mirror, 50mm.	VIKRAM You can hold on. I don't bite. <i>Pattukovacchu. Nenem karavanu.</i>
1.9 She does not hold on. But she does not let go of the rail either. Title card over the city: PENTHOUSE. CAMERA Drone: high wide following the bike across the flyover into the sunrise, 24mm equivalent. Title card over the plate.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot platform at blue hour; extras only as out-of-focus shapes (no faces sharp, no dialogue). Bike ride on tracking vehicle with Rani side-saddle; stunt-safe speed under 20 km/h, closed road permissions for Tank Bund. Title card PENTHOUSE is a post graphic over the Gachibowli skyline plate. Phone V.O. recorded clean in studio.

SCENE 2 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — MORNING

Scene No.	2	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — hall cum kitchen and terrace door	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 06:45–07:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V1: black T-shirt, jeans		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Messy dressing: pizza boxes, ashtray on floor, clothes over couch, beer cans in cooler box, sink full of mugs, event lanyards on nail, rolled banner "NEON NIGHTS — SATURDAY", garbage bags. Furniture: 3-seater couch, small dining counter with 2 stools, two-burner stove, fridge, balcony door. Terrace: plastic chair, 6 dead potted plants, water tank. Vikram's second phone (older model)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
2.1 The door opens on chaos. Pizza boxes. An ashtray on the floor. Three days of clothes over the couch. A cooler box of beer cans by the fridge. The sink a museum of mugs. Event-company lanyards hang from a nail. A large rolled banner says "NEON NIGHTS — SATURDAY". CAMERA POV from doorway, 24mm, eye level; slow pan across the mess. Inserts on ashtray, sink, banner (50mm).	—
2.2 Vikram drops her trunk and kicks a shoe under the couch, too late. CAMERA WIDE master, 24mm from front door; both in frame.	VIKRAM It's — normally it's cleaner. <i>Adi — maamoolugaa inkaa neetgaa untundi.</i> RANI <i>(taking it in)</i> Normally. <i>Maamoolugaa.</i> VIKRAM Okay, it's never cleaner. Event week. I sleep four hours. <i>Sare, eppudoo ilaage untundi. Event week. Naalugu gantale nidra.</i>

2.3 He opens the balcony door. Light pours in, and the view opens out across the city: a terrace bigger than the flat itself, a plastic chair, dead plants in pots. CAMERA Reverse from terrace looking in as door opens, 35mm; light flare entering. Cut to wide of terrace, 24mm.	VIKRAM The real house is outside. The flat is just where I keep my mess. <i>Asalu illu bayata undi. Lopala unnadi naa chetta daachukune chotu maatrame.</i>
2.4 Rani steps onto the terrace slowly. Wind lifts the end of her pallu. For the first time we see her face fully relax. She closes her eyes. CAMERA Slow dolly behind her stepping out, 35mm; cut to CU face, 85mm, slight low angle against open sky. Insert: pallu lifting in wind (100mm, 48fps).	RANI So much sky. <i>Enta aakaashamo.</i> VIKRAM You like it? <i>Nacchindaa?</i> RANI In my in-laws' house there was one window. It faced a wall. <i>Maa attaarintlo okkate kitikee undedi. Adi koodaa goda vaipe.</i>
2.5 She says it lightly. He hears it heavily. He leans in the doorway. CAMERA MCU Vikram in the doorway frame, 50mm, eye level; door frame as a frame-within-frame.	VIKRAM Listen. Amma told me everything — I mean, not everything. That you need a job. That you need a place. Here, this place — feel like it's your own home. Okay? Not guest. Home. <i>Vinandi. Amma antaa cheppindi — ante, antaa kaadu. Meeku udyogam kaavaalani. Undataaniki chotu kaavaalani. Ee illu — mee sonta illu anukondi. Sarenaa? Gest kaadu. Illu.</i> RANI People say that. <i>Andaroo alaage antaaru.</i> VIKRAM I'm not people. I'm the neighbour's son who stole mangoes from your Amamma's tree. She chased me with a broom. <i>Nenu andarilaantodini kaadu. Mee Amamma chettu maamidikaayalu dongilinchina pakkinti pillodini. Cheepuru pattukuni tarimindi nannu.</i>

2.6 Rani laughs — a real, surprised laugh — and covers her mouth with her hand, as if laughing is something she must apologise for. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; hold through the laugh and the hand to her mouth.	VIKRAM See? Home. <i>Chooshaaraa? Ille.</i>
2.7 She turns back to the flat, looks at the mess, and quietly begins tying her pallu at her waist. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: hands tucking pallu at waist. MS two-shot as he protests.	VIKRAM No, no, no — you just came. Rest. <i>Vaddu vaddu vaddu — ippude vacchaaru. Kaasepu rest teesukondi.</i> RANI I rest better in a clean room. <i>Shubhrangaa unna gadilone naaku rest baaguntundi.</i>
2.8 She picks up the first pizza box. He watches, embarrassed, then grabs a garbage bag and starts helping. They work in silence. When their hands reach for the same mug, they both let go and it nearly falls. He catches it. CAMERA WIDE master, 24mm, for the silent cleaning (can run as a short time-lapse). Insert, 100mm: two hands on one mug; slow-motion catch at 60fps.	VIKRAM Reflexes. Event manager. <i>Reflexes. Event manager kadaa.</i> RANI What does an event manager do? <i>Event manager ante em chestaaru?</i>
2.9 The smallest pause. CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm; hold one beat.	VIKRAM Makes sure people get what they paid for. <i>Janam deniki dabbu kattaaro, adi vaallaki andelaa choostaadu.</i>
2.10 His phone — a second phone, older, in his back pocket — vibrates. He glances at it, silences it, puts it face down on the fridge. Rani does not notice. The camera does. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: phone vibrating in back pocket; rack focus to Rani in background unaware. Final insert: phone face down on fridge top.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Establish the flat's geography here for the whole film: one master wide from the front door covering couch, counter, stove and terrace door. Mess must be photographed for continuity (it returns in Scene 28). The second phone is a planted clue: one clean insert, never emphasised by music.

SCENE 3 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — NIGHT

Scene No.	3	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom doorway, bed	Story day, date & time	Day 1 · Mon 9 June · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5: soft grey cotton saree worn for sleep VIKRAM — Costume V2: grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Double bed with white sheet, 3 pillows (the "China border"), extra pillow in Vikram's hand, split AC unit (practical with hum), window with city view, bedsheet folded on couch, clean mugs in a row on counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
3.1 The flat is transformed: floors mopped, a bedsheet on the couch, the mugs in rows. Vikram stands in the bedroom doorway holding a pillow. CAMERA WIDE from bedroom looking out to hall, 24mm; reveal the cleaned flat. MS Vikram in doorway, 50mm.	VIKRAM Bed's yours. I'm on the couch. <i>Bed meedi. Nenu sofalo padukuntaa.</i> RANI No. Your house, your bed. I'll sleep on the couch. <i>Vaddu. Mee illu, mee bed. Nene sofalo padukuntaa.</i> VIKRAM There's no AC in the hall. It's thirty-four degrees at midnight. You'll melt. <i>Hall-lo AC ledu. Ardharatri koodaa muppai naalugu digreelu. Karigipotaaru.</i> RANI I've slept on floors in May with no fan. Thirty-four is nothing. <i>Me nelalo fan koodaa lekundaa nela meeda padukunnaa. Muppai naalugu em lekka.</i> VIKRAM That's exactly why you're not sleeping on the couch. <i>Sariggaa anduke meeru sofalo padukovadaaniki veelledu.</i>

3.2 She stops. He did not mean it as a punch, but it lands. She looks down. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eyes dropping. Reverse CU Vikram realising, 85mm.	VIKRAM <i>(softer)</i> Sorry. I mean — you've done enough of that. Take the bed. <i>Sorry. Ante — alaantivi ippatike chaalaa cheshaaru. Bed teesukondi.</i> RANI And you will sweat on a couch for two weeks because of me? I'll feel guilty every night. Guilt is hotter than May. <i>Naa valla meeru rendu vaaraalu sofalo chematalu kakkutaaraa? Rojoo raatri naaku gilteegaa untundi. Aa gilt me enda kante vedi.</i>
3.3 They stand at an impasse. He tries a different route. CAMERA Symmetrical two-shot, 35mm, eye level; bed between them in frame.	VIKRAM Fine. Couch for you. Then I'll also sleep in the hall, on the floor, out of protest. Both of us will melt. The AC will cool an empty room. Very sensible. <i>Sare. Sofa meeke. Ayite nenu koodaa nirasanaagaa hall-lo nela meeda padukuntaa. Iddaram karigipodaam. AC khaalee gadini challabarustundi. Chaalaa telivaina pani.</i>
3.4 She almost laughs again. She looks at the bed. It is large. She looks at him. CAMERA Her POV: the bed, 35mm. Back to MCU Rani, 50mm.	RANI It's a big bed. <i>Bed peddade.</i> VIKRAM It's a very big bed. <i>Chaalaa pedda bed.</i>
3.5 A long beat. CAMERA Hold the two-shot; no cut.	RANI One side each. Pillows in the middle. <i>Okkokkariki oka vaipu. Madhyalo dindlu.</i> VIKRAM A wall. Like the China border. <i>Oka goda. China border laagaa.</i> RANI Like the China border. <i>China border laagaa.</i>

3.6 LATER. Lights off. The AC hums. A blue strip of city light falls across the bed. Between them, a wall of three pillows. Both lie on their backs, eyes open, staring at the ceiling.

CAMERA Top shot (overhead), 24mm, rigged on a ceiling mount: two bodies, three pillows between. Lock off.

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3.7 Her hand is folded over her mangalsutra-less neck — a habit she has not broken. He notices it in the half light.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand at her bare neck. Side profile two-shot at mattress level, 50mm.

VIKRAM (*whispering*)

Are you sleeping?

Nidrapoyaaraa?

RANI

No.

Ledu.

VIKRAM

Me neither.

Nenoo ledu.

RANI

I haven't slept in a room with AC before.

AC gadilo intaku mundeppudoo padukoledu.

VIKRAM

How is it?

Elaa undi?

RANI

Too quiet. In the village there are dogs, buffaloes, Ammamma snoring. Here I can hear my own heart.

Maree nishshabdangaa undi. Oorlo kukkalu, gedelu, Ammamma guraka.

Ikkada naa gunde chappude naaku vinipistondi.

VIKRAM

What's it saying?

Adi emantondi?

3.8 She takes a long time to answer. CAMERA CU Rani on pillow, 85mm, lit only by the blue strip.	RANI That I left my children in a village and came to a stranger's house in a city I don't know. <i>Pillalni oorlo vadilesi, teliyani oorlo, paraayi manishi intiki vacchaanani.</i> VIKRAM I'm not a stranger. Mango thief. Remember? <i>Nenu paraayivaadini kaadu. Maamidikaayala dongani. Gurtundaa?</i> RANI Mango thief. <i>Maamidikaayala donga.</i>
3.9 She turns on her side, away from him. He turns on his side, away from her. Two backs, one pillow wall. Hold the shot long enough to become uncomfortable. Slow fade. CAMERA Return to overhead, 24mm; hold 15 seconds; slow fade to black.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Night interior: motivated blue city-light strip through the window (LED tube outside with diffusion), AC practical on for sound. Record room tone with AC on. Pillow-wall count must be tracked across scenes: 3 here, 2 after Scene 8, 1 by Scene 13, gone after.

SCENE 4 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NEXT MORNING

Scene No.	4	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — hall cum kitchen	Story day, date & time	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 08:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R3: fresh sky-blue cotton saree, hair wet and loose-knotted VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts, barefoot		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Kadai with tadka (mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic — real cooking), steel plate of upma, steel tumbler and dabara of filter coffee, spoon, washed curtains drying on terrace rail, couch cover turned to clean side, dead plants lined in a row on terrace, Vikram's main phone on bed (referenced), counter stool		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
4.1 Vikram wakes alone in the bed. He hears a sizzle. He smells something he has not smelled in this flat in two years: tadka. Mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic. CAMERA MCU Vikram waking, 50mm, high angle. Insert, 100mm: mustard seeds popping in the kadai (high frame rate).	—
4.2 He walks out barefoot, hair wild. The hall is unrecognisable. Curtains washed and drying on the terrace rail. The couch cover turned inside out to its clean side. A steel plate of upma on the counter, a tumbler of filter coffee beside it. The dead plants on the terrace have been lined up in a row, untouched. CAMERA Steadicam following Vikram from bedroom into hall, 24mm; reveal the transformed space in one move.	—

4.3 Rani is at the stove in a fresh cotton saree, hair still wet, a single strand stuck to her neck. She hums an old Telugu film song, very softly, and stops the moment she sees him.

CAMERA MS Rani at stove in profile, 50mm, backlit by the window. Insert, 100mm: wet strand of hair on her neck.

VIKRAM

You're humming.

Meeru paata ham chestunnaaru.

RANI

I wasn't.

Ledu.

VIKRAM

You were. Ghantasala.

Chestunnaaru. Ghantasala.

RANI

My father's songs. Eat before it gets cold.

Maa naannagaari paatalu. Challaarakamunde tinandi.

4.4 He sits on the counter stool and eats. Closes his eyes on the first mouthful.

CAMERA CU Vikram eating, 85mm; hold the eyes closing (callback shot for Scene 31).

VIKRAM

Where did you even get rava? I don't own rava.

Asalu ravva ekkadidi? Naa intlo ravve ledu.

RANI

You own a grocery app. I found it on your phone.

Mee daggara grocery app undi. Mee phonelo chooshaa.

4.5 He freezes for half a second.

CAMERA Push-in on Vikram, 85mm, 1-second creep.

VIKRAM

Which phone?

E phonelo?

RANI

The one on the bed. Why, you have two?

Bed meeda unnadaantlo. Em, rendu unnaayaa?

VIKRAM *(easy smile)*

One for clients, one for Amma. Amma calls too much.

Okati clientski, okati Ammaki. Amma maree ekkuva phone chestundi.

RANI

She worries. Mothers worry.

Kangaaru padutundi. Ammalante.

4.6 She turns back to the stove. He eats watching her back. Something in his face softens and calculates at the same time. CAMERA OTS from behind Vikram onto Rani's back at the stove, 50mm; then CU Vikram, 85mm, for the double read.	VIKRAM What do you want to do? For work. <i>Meerem cheyaalanukuntunnaaru? Udyogangaa.</i> RANI Anything that pays. I can cook. I can clean. I studied till ninth class. I can sew blouses. I can do accounts in my head faster than your calculator. <i>Dabbulocche e panainaa. Vanta cheyagalanu. Illu shubhram cheyagalanu. Tommido taragati varaku chadivaa. Jacketlu kuttagalanu. Mee calculator kante vegangaa manasulone lekkalu veyagalanu.</i> VIKRAM Ninth class? <i>Tommido taragatenaa?</i> RANI Then I got married. <i>Tarvaata pellaipoyindi.</i>
4.7 She says it to the frying pan. He puts the spoon down. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: spoon set down on the steel plate. MCU Rani facing the stove, 85mm.	VIKRAM At what age? <i>Ennellaki?</i> RANI Coffee is getting cold. <i>Coffee challaaripotondi.</i>
4.8 He takes the hint. Drinks the coffee. She does not turn around. CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, from the terrace door: her back, him drinking. Hold.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Real tadka on set for sizzle and steam; food stylist on standby, keep 3 identical plates of upma for takes. Morning daylight through terrace door (HMI outside, 5600K). Rani's humming must be an original or cleared tune; the same tune recurs in Scenes 15 and 31.

SCENE 5

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE MORNING

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	5 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — dead-plant corner by the water tank	Story day, date & time	Day 2 · Tue 10 June · 11:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R3: sky-blue cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	6 terracotta pots with dry soil, jasmine root and tulasi root (greens dept: live cutting with visible pale-green root), plastic bucket filled with water, steel mug, small trowel (unused — he digs with hands), plastic chair, Vikram's phone		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
5.1 The Terrace Garden. Rani kneels among the dead pots, sifting dry soil through her fingers. Vikram ends a call on the terrace and watches her. CAMERA WIDE from the water tank, 35mm, Vikram foreground soft ending his call, Rani sharp among the pots. Insert, 100mm: soil running through her fingers.	VIKRAM Those are dead. I killed them in March. <i>Avi chacchipoyaayi. Maarchilo nene champeshaa.</i> RANI Nothing is dead if the root is alive. Look. <i>Veru batikunte edee chacchiponatte. Choodandi.</i>

5.2 She holds up a thin, pale-green root. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: root against the sky, shallow focus. Then MCU Rani, 50mm, low angle.	RANI This is jasmine. And this one, tulasi. You had a tulasi and you let it die? Amamma would beat you with the same broom. <i>Idi malle. Idi tulasi. Intlo tulasi pettukuni endiponicchaaraa? Amamma ade cheepuruto kodutundi mimmalni.</i> VIKRAM What do I do? <i>Nenem cheyaali?</i> RANI Bring water. Not too much. Plants are like people. Too much love also drowns them. <i>Neellu teesukurandi. Maree ekkuva kaadu. Mokkaloo manushullaantive. Prema ekkuvainaa munigipotaayi.</i>
5.3 He brings a full bucket and pours far too much. Mud splashes up across his mouth and chin. She bursts out laughing. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm, eye level from pot height. Splash at 60fps for a gentle slow-motion beat.	RANI Mango thief. Exactly the same face. <i>Maamidikaayala donga. Accham ade moham.</i>
5.4 She wipes his cheek with the end of her pallu, then realises how close she is. She stops. He does not move. CAMERA Tight two-shot in profile, 85mm; the gap between faces centred. Hold.	VIKRAM You didn't finish. <i>Inkaa poortigaa tudavaledu.</i>
5.5 She hesitates, then wipes the rest, slowly. Their eyes meet and hold. She steps back and busies herself with the pot. CAMERA Alternating CUs, 85mm, eye-line matched. Return to MS as she pulls away.	RANI In fifteen days, this will flower. <i>Padihenu rojullo idi poostundi.</i> VIKRAM You'll be here in fifteen days? <i>Padihenu rojulaki meeru ikkade untaaraa?</i> RANI The plant will be here. That's enough. <i>Mokka untundi kadaa. Adi chaalu.</i>

5.6 He kneels beside her and digs with his bare hands. They plant together in silence while the city hums below. Close on two pairs of muddy hands pressing soil around one root. This jasmine returns in Scene 29.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: two pairs of muddy hands round one root. Crane/jib up and back to a high wide of two figures and the skyline, 24mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot between 10:30 and 11:30 for hard top-light softened by a 12x12 silk. Mud splash is practical: prepare 3 clean T-shirts (V3 doubles) and face wipes. Plant the jasmine pot in a fixed, marked position — the same pot must show a bud in Scene 16 and full flowers in Scene 29.

SCENE 6 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — EVENING

Scene No.	6	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, on the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 4 · Thu 12 June · 18:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: faded green cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Vikram's laptop (job portal open, rejection emails — screen replacement or live graphics), Rani's one-page résumé on screen, 2 glass cups of chai, pillow wall (3 pillows, one slightly flattened), bedside table, Vikram's second phone (screen shows "L — Spa")		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
6.1 Rani sits cross-legged on the bed with Vikram's laptop, two-finger typing. A job portal is open. A dozen tabs. Three rejection emails. Vikram enters with two cups of chai. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: two fingers typing. OTS onto screen, 50mm. MS Vikram entering doorway with chai, 35mm.	VIKRAM How many? <i>Enni?</i> RANI Twenty-two applications. Three replies. All said "graduate preferred". <i>Iravai rendu aplikeshanlu. Moodu replies. Annee "Graadyuyet preferred" annaayi.</i> VIKRAM Preferred isn't required. <i>Preferred ante tappanisari kaadu.</i> RANI In this city, preferred is required. <i>Ee oorlo preferred antene tappanisari.</i>

6.2 He sits beside her — on her side of the pillow wall, which is still there, slightly flattened. He scrolls her résumé. It is one page, plain, honest.

CAMERA Two-shot from foot of bed, 35mm; the pillow wall visible behind them. Insert of résumé on screen.

VIKRAM

Date of marriage you've written here. Why?

Ikkada pelli tedee raashaaru. Enduku?

RANI

The form asked for marital status. I didn't know what to write. Married, divorced — both are lies in a way.

Formlo myaarital status adigaaru. Em raayaalo teliyaledu. Pellayindi, vidaakulayyaayi — oka rakangaa rendoo abaddhaale.

VIKRAM

Divorced is not a lie.

Vidaakulu abaddham kaadu.

RANI

It is a court paper. The marriage was the lie.

Adi kortu kaagitam. Pelle asalu abaddham.

6.3 He sets the laptop aside. Waits. She looks at the chai.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, across 40 seconds of the speech that follows.

RANI

I was thirteen and a half. He was twenty-six. My father had a heart attack and wanted to see me "settled" before he died. He died anyway. Three months after the wedding.

Naaku padamoodunnara. Ataniki iravai aaru. Naannagaariki gundepotu vacchindi, poyelopu nannu "Settle" cheyaalanukunnaaru. Ayinaa poyaaru. Pellayina moodu nelalake.

VIKRAM

Thirteen.

Padamoodu.

RANI

And a half. I was proud of the half. I thought it made me older.

Ara koodaa. Aa ara ante naaku garvangaa undedi. Daanito peddadaannayyaa anukunnaa.

6.4 She laughs. It comes out wrong. He does not laugh.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, unmoving.

RANI

Sravya was born when I was fifteen. Kiran when I was sixteen. Everyone at the hospital thought I was the elder sister. The nurse asked where the mother was.

Naaku padihenellappudu Sravya puttindi. Padahaarellappudu Kiran.

Aaspatrilo andaroo nannu akka anukunnaaru. Nars "Amma ekkada?" ani adigindi.

VIKRAM

And now they're in college.

Ippudu vaallu collegelo unnaaru.

RANI *(lighting up)*

Sravya is in final year B.Com. Kiran in second year engineering. Both first class. Both.

Sravya beekaam final year. Kiran injaneering second year. Iddaroo fast class. Iddaroo.

VIKRAM

You did that.

Adi meeru chesinde.

RANI

Ammamma did that. I only — survived.

Adi Ammamma chesindi. Nenu kevalam — batikaanu.

VIKRAM

That's not only.

Adi "Kevalam" kaadu.

6.5 She looks at him. He holds the look. She breaks it first and picks up the laptop.

CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm; she breaks eye-line first.

RANI

Help me write "preferred" things.

"Preferred" vishayaalu raayadaaniki saayam cheyandi.

VIKRAM

We'll write true things. Twenty years managing a household of eight people. Accounts. Cooking. Child education. That's management. You're more qualified than half my clients.

Nijamainave raaddaam. Enimidi mandi unna intini iravai ellu nadipaaru.

Lekkalu. Vanta. Pillala chaduvu. Ade menejment. Naa clientslo sagam mandi kante meeke ekkuva arhata undi.

RANI

What clients?

E clients?

VIKRAM

Rich people who need someone to arrange their happiness.

Tama santoshaanni verevaro erpaatu cheyaalanukune dabbunnollu.

6.6 She smiles at the phrase. On the bedside table, his second phone lights up silently. A name on the screen: "L — Spa". He turns it over.

CAMERA Rack focus from Rani's smile (foreground) to the glowing phone on the bedside table (background), 85mm. His hand enters and flips it.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Laptop screens: prepare live graphics of a job portal, three rejections reading "graduate preferred", and the résumé page; avoid real company names. Golden-hour practicals: bedside lamp on plus warm window bounce. The "L — Spa" caller ID is a planted clue: a single insert only.

SCENE 7 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	7 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — stove, couch	Story day, date & time	Day 5 · Fri 13 June · 21:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V5: black hoodie, joggers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Steel milk vessel, tea strainer, ladle, tea powder packet (delivery packaging), sugar jar, 2 steel tumblers / glass cups, kitchen sink, couch. Burn-safe milk boil-over rig (pre-boiled milk, low flame)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
7.1 The First Tea. Rani heads for the stove. Vikram steps into her path. CAMERA MS two-shot, 35mm, from the couch looking toward the kitchen.	VIKRAM Sit. Tonight I make tea. <i>Koorchondi. Ee roju tea nenu chestaa.</i> RANI You? You don't own tea powder. <i>Meeraa? Mee intlo tea pode ledu.</i> VIKRAM I own a grocery app. <i>Naa daggara grocery app undi kadaa.</i>
7.2 She laughs and sits on the couch, but keeps half-rising, unable to sit while someone else works. Each time, he points the ladle at her and she sits back down. The milk boils over. He burns a finger and swears under his breath. He adds sugar three times. He brings two cups: the tea pale, overboiled, far too sweet. CAMERA Comic master from the couch, 24mm, both in frame for the half-rising gag. Inserts, 100mm: milk boiling over; three spoons of sugar. MS as he carries two cups.	—

7.3 Rani takes a sip. Her face does something complicated. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eye level.	VIKRAM Bad? <i>Baaledaa?</i> RANI Terrible. <i>Ghorangaa undi.</i>
7.4 She drinks it anyway, slowly, holding the cup in both hands. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: both hands round the cup. Slow push-in to MCU as she speaks, 85mm.	VIKRAM You don't have to finish it. <i>Mottam taagakkarledu.</i> RANI In thirty-five years, nobody has made me tea. Not once. Not my husband, not his mother, not even when I had fever after Kiran. I made tea for everyone and drank what was left at the bottom of the vessel, cold. This is the first cup anyone made only for me. Even if it's terrible, I'll finish it. <i>Muppai aidellalo evvaroo naaku tea chesi ivvaledu. Okkasaari koodaa. Naa bharta kaadu, attagaaru kaadu, Kiran puttaaka jvaram vacchinappudu koodaa. Andarikee nene tea cheshaa, ginne aduguna migilindi challagaa taagaa. Naa okkadaani kosam evaro chesina modati kappu idi. Ghorangaa unnna poortigaa taagutaa.</i>
7.5 He is quiet. He takes her empty cup to the sink. She stands to wash it; he gently presses her back down by the shoulder. CAMERA MS, 50mm; insert of his hand on her shoulder pressing her down.	VIKRAM From tomorrow, morning coffee is yours. Evening tea is mine. Deal? <i>Repata nunchi podduna coffee meedi. Saayantram tea naadi. Deel?</i> RANI Even if it's terrible? <i>Ghorangaa unnna?</i> VIKRAM Especially if it's terrible. <i>Ghorangaa untene maree.</i>

7.6 She laughs, wiping her eye with the back of her wrist. He blows on his burnt finger. She takes his hand, inspects the small burn, and without thinking blows on it too, the way she would for her children. Both realise it at the same moment. She does not let go immediately. Hold. Then she does.

CAMERA Static two-shot, 85mm, framed on the joined hands and both faces. Hold the realisation; no cut until she lets go.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Warm tungsten practicals only (kitchen tube off, under-cabinet strip on) to keep it cosy. Milk boil-over: art department to rig a controlled overflow; protect the hob. The burnt finger is a mime — no heat contact. Her blowing on his finger is the scene's key image; hold it on a static 85mm.

SCENE 8 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN / TERRACE — NIGHT, RAIN

Scene No.	8	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — couch, with rain on the terrace beyond the glass; bedroom at the end	Story day, date & time	Day 7 · Sun 15 June · 22:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V2: grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	1 — Arrival
Props & furniture	Phone torch (Vikram's phone), drawer of event leftovers, 2 gold scented vanilla candles, matchbox, couch, rain on terrace, pillow wall (3 pillows → she removes one, leaving 2)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
8.1 A thunderstorm. The power goes out with a pop. Total dark, then lightning lights up the room in white flashes. Rani is on the couch, knees pulled to her chest. Vikram comes out of the bedroom with his phone torch. CAMERA WIDE, 24mm, locked off; lightning strobes reveal Rani in flashes. Handheld MS following Vikram's torch beam, 35mm.	VIKRAM You okay? <i>Baagaane unnaaraa?</i> RANI Yes. Thunder. Only thunder. <i>Aa. Urumu. Urumu maatrame.</i>
8.2 She is shaking. He sets the phone torch upright on the table so it bounces off the ceiling. He lights two candles from a drawer of event leftovers. Gold, scented, absurd. Vanilla. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: match flaring, candle wick catching. MS two-shot on couch, 50mm, candlelight key.	VIKRAM Event stock. Very romantic. Sorry. <i>Event stock. Maree romanticgaa undi. Sorry.</i>
8.3 He sits on the far end of the couch. The rain hammers the terrace. A long silence. CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, couch length between them; rain on the glass behind.	RANI He used to come home on nights like this. <i>Ilaanti raatrulle atanu intiki vacchevaadu.</i>

8.4 Vikram does not ask who. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; he looks at her, says nothing.	RANI He worked in a liquor depot. When it rained, the trucks stopped, so he came home early. Drunk. Lightning — then him. Lightning — then him. My body still thinks they come together. <i>Atanu likkar dipolo pani chesevaadu. Varsham padite laareelu aagipoyevi, anduke tvaragaa intikocchevaadu. Taagi. Merupu — tarvaata atanu. Merupu — tarvaata atanu. Aa rendoo kalise vastaayani naa ontiki ippatikee anipistundi.</i> VIKRAM You don't have to tell me. <i>Naaku cheppaalsina avasaram ledi.</i> RANI No one has ever asked to hear it. Ammamma knows. But she says "forget". You cannot forget with the body. <i>Idi vinaalani evvaroo eppudoo adagaledu. Ammammani telusu. Kaanee "Marchipo" antundi. Ollu marchipodu.</i>
8.5 She pulls the pallu over her shoulder tighter. CAMERA Single on Rani, 85mm, candlelit, slow push-in through the next three lines (one continuous take).	RANI My father promised two lakhs and five tolas of gold. He died before he could pay half. So for twenty years I was the unpaid half. My mother-in-law said it every morning with the coffee: "Even your father didn't think you were worth paying for." <i>Maa naannagaaru rendu lakshalu, aidu tulaala bangaaram istaanannaaru. Sagam koodaa ivvakamunde poyaaru. Anduke iravai ellu nenu aa kattani sagaanni. Prati podduna coffeeto paatu attagaaru ade anedi: "Nee kosam dabba kattanta viluva neekundani mee naanna koodaa anukoledu."</i>
8.6 Thunder. She flinches. CAMERA Lightning flash on the same take; do not cut.	RANI When I was seven months with Kiran, they wanted me to ask Ammamma to sell her land for the balance. I refused. He kicked me. Here. <i>Kiran kadupulo edo nelappudu, baakee kosam Ammammani polam Ammammani adagamannaaru. Nenu oppukoledu. Atanu tannaadu. Ikkada.</i>

8.7 She touches her lower back, near the hip. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her hand touching her lower back (this exact spot returns in Scene 25).	RANI I held on to the kitchen door so I wouldn't fall on my stomach. All I thought was — don't fall forward. Don't fall forward. The baby. I fell backwards on purpose. I broke my wrist instead. <i>Kadupu meeda padakundaa vantinti talupu pattukunnaa. Okkate anukunnaa — munduku padakoodadu. Munduku padakoodadu. Bidda. Kaavaalane venakki paddaa. Badulugaa manikattu virigindi.</i>
8.8 Her voice is steady. Her face is wet. She does not seem to know she is crying. CAMERA ECU, 100mm: tear on her cheek catching candlelight; eyes steady.	RANI In the hospital they wrote "slipped in bathroom". I signed it. With the left hand, because the right was in plaster. My signature looked like a child's. I suppose it was. <i>Aaspatrilo "Baatroonlo jaaripadindi" ani raashaaru. Nenu santakam cheshaa. Edama chetto, endukante kudi chetiki kattu undi. Naa santakam chinnapilla santakanlaa undi. Bahushaa nijangaa ade.</i>
8.9 Vikram slides closer. Stops. Waits. She looks at him, then at the space between them, and nods once. He puts his arm around her shoulder. She stiffens — her whole body like a fist — then, with a sound that is half a breath and half a sob, she collapses into him and cries properly, the way she has not let herself cry in twenty years. Hard, ugly, loud, the rain covering it. CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm, eye level on the couch; hold the slide, the nod, the collapse in one take. Then a slow orbit (slider arc) around them, 35mm.	VIKRAM Cry. Nobody's listening. Only the rain. And it's on your side. <i>Edavandi. Evaroo vinatledu. Varsham maatrame. Adi koodaa mee vaipe.</i>
8.10 She cries harder. He rocks her slightly. The candle flames tremble. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: candle flames trembling. Back to tight two-shot, 85mm.	RANI <i>(muffled)</i> Why did I stay so long? <i>Anta kaalam enduku undipoyaanu?</i> VIKRAM Because you were thirteen when you got there. You don't leave the only house you know at thirteen. You leave when the kids are safe. You left the day they were safe. That's not late. That's exactly on time. <i>Endukante akkadiki velletappatiki meeku padamoodellu. Padamoodellaki telisina okka intinee evaroo vadalaru. Pillalu safe ayyaake vadulutaaru. Vaallu safe ayina roje meeru vadilesaaru. Adi aalasyam kaadu. Sariggaa samayaanike.</i>

8.11 She pulls back. Looks at him like no one has ever said that to her. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram, 85mm.	RANI Who taught you to talk like this? <i>Ilaa maatlaadatam meeku evaru nerpaaru?</i> VIKRAM My job. People tell me their problems at three a.m. <i>Naa udyogam. Tellavaarujaamu moodintiki janam vaalla baadhalannee naake cheptaaru.</i>
8.12 The lights come back on with a hum. They both blink, suddenly exposed. Her face swollen. His T-shirt wet with her tears. She moves away, embarrassed, wiping her face with the pallu. CAMERA Hard light change on cue (practicals snap on); MS two-shot, 35mm. Insert of tear-wet patch on his vest.	RANI I made your shirt dirty. <i>Mee shirt muriki cheshaa.</i> VIKRAM It was dirty before. You just washed it. <i>Munde murikigaa undi. Meeru ippude utikaaru.</i>
8.13 She laughs through the tears. He gets up, turns off the overhead light, leaves the candles burning. CAMERA Wide, 24mm: back to candlelight as he kills the overhead.	VIKRAM Come. Bed. The AC is on our side too. <i>Randi. Padukundaam. AC koodaa mana vaipe.</i>
8.14 She follows him. In the bedroom, she stops at the pillow wall. Looks at it. Takes one pillow out of the three and places it at the foot of the bed. Two left. A smaller border. CAMERA Steadicam behind her into the bedroom, 35mm. Insert, 50mm: one pillow placed at the foot of the bed.	—
8.15 He sees it. Says nothing. They lie down. This time, she faces his side of the bed. Her eyes close. His stay open, watching her, and we cannot read him. Fade out. CAMERA Overhead, 24mm (matching Scene 3): two pillows now. Then CU Vikram's open eyes, 85mm, neutral light. Fade.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Rain towers on the terrace outside the glass; lightning via programmed strobe units (Lightning Strikes or LED equivalent) cued to sound. Blackout: all practicals cut, torch-bounce plus candlelight only (shoot wide open, high ISO). This is the film's emotional anchor: allow long uninterrupted takes for Rani's monologue; minimal crew in the room. The pillow count leaves at 2.

SCENE 9 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — DAY

Scene No.	9	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, wardrobe corner behind the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 14:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: faded green cotton saree, pallu tucked at waist VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos, keys in hand		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bed on castor sliders (to drag), loose plywood panel at wardrobe base, hidden shelf: 4 whisky bottles, 1 rum, 1 vodka with frosted label, 2 cigarette cartons, Zippo lighter, box of hotel cocktail stirrers, slim ledger book with rubber band, plastic pouch of SIM cards; cigarette packet (prop/herbal), wardrobe mirror, broom and duster		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
9.1 Vikram is out. Rani, alone, is deep-cleaning the bedroom with the energy of someone who has nowhere else to put her nerves. She drags the bed away from the wall. Behind it, a loose plywood panel at the base of the wardrobe. She pulls it. CAMERA WIDE, 24mm, high angle from the corner: energetic cleaning. MS as she strains to drag the bed, 35mm. Insert, 50mm: her fingers prying the panel.	—
9.2 Behind it: a hidden shelf. Four bottles of whisky, one rum, one vodka with a frosted label, two cartons of cigarettes, a Zippo lighter, a box of cocktail stirrers from some hotel event. And, pushed far back, a slim ledger book with a rubber band around it, and a plastic pouch of SIM cards. She does not touch the ledger. She picks up a cigarette packet and turns it over in her hands like an artefact from another planet. CAMERA Her POV into the shelf, 35mm, slow reveal. Rack focus: bottles front → ledger and SIM pouch at the back (clue). Insert, 100mm: cigarette packet turning in her hands.	—

9.3 She sniffs it. Smiles. Glances at the door. Puts one between her lips, unlit, and looks at herself in the wardrobe mirror. A woman in a cotton saree with a cigarette. She looks ridiculous. She looks thrilling. She takes it out fast when she hears a key in the door. CAMERA Mirror shot, 50mm: her reflection with the cigarette, camera on her shoulder line. Sound cue: key in the lock.	—
9.4 Vikram walks in, sees the bed moved, sees the open panel, sees her with the packet behind her back. His face goes very still for a moment — his eyes flick to the ledger, which is untouched — and then he grins. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; his eye-line flicks to the ledger (cut-in insert, 100mm, ledger untouched), back to him grinning.	VIKRAM You found my temple. <i>Naa gudini kanipetteshaaru.</i> RANI I was cleaning. <i>Shubhram chestunnaa.</i> VIKRAM Behind the wardrobe. <i>Beeruvaa venakaala?</i> RANI Dust doesn't respect wardrobes. <i>Dummuki beeruvaa ante gauravam undadu.</i>
9.5 He sits on the bed, amused. She brings her hand out from behind her back. The cigarette packet. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm, him seated, her standing — she is taller in the frame for once.	RANI I wasn't going to — <i>Nenem taagalani kaadu —</i> VIKRAM Have you ever? <i>Eppudainaa try cheshaaraa?</i>

9.6 She shakes her head. Then, quietly:

CAMERA MCU Rani, 85mm, slight high angle; she sits on the floor by the open panel through the speech.

RANI

Can I tell you something you'll laugh at?

Meeru navve oka vishayam cheppanaa?

VIKRAM

Definitely.

Kacchitangaa navvutaa.

RANI

Every evening for twenty years, he would sit on the veranda and smoke and drink, and I would bring him water and pickle and onions. And I used to stand in the kitchen and watch the smoke go up. And I thought — what does it feel like to sit down? Not the smoke. The sitting down. With something in your hand that is only for you.

Iravai ellu prati saayantram atanu varandaalo koorchuni cigarette, mandu taagevaadu. Nenu neellu, ooragaaya, ullipaayalu tecchi pettedaanni.

Vantintlo nilabadi aa poga paiki veltunte choosedaanni. Anukunedaanni — adi elaa untundo? Poga kaadu. Koorchovadam. Chetilo naa okkadaanide ayina edo okati pattukuni koorchovadam.

9.7 He doesn't laugh.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, still.

RANI

I used to sniff his glass when I washed it. Like a thief. In-laws said women who drink are — you know what they said.

Atani glaasu kadugutunnappudu vaasana choosedanni. Dongalaa. Taage aadavaallu — attaarintlo emanevaaro meeku telusu.

VIKRAM

I know what they said.

Emanevaaro telusu.

RANI

Ammamma would die.

Ammamma chacchipotundi.

VIKRAM

Ammamma drinks toddy on Sankranti. I've seen her.

Sankrantiki Ammamma kallu taagutundi. Nenu chooshaa.

RANI (*shocked, delighted*)

Liar!

Abaddhaalakoru!

VIKRAM

Ask my mother.

Maa Ammani adagandi.

9.8 She laughs so hard she sits down on the floor. He watches her laugh, and something in him decides.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, she on the floor laughing; push-in to CU Vikram, 85mm, as the decision forms.

VIKRAM

Tonight. Terrace. Class number one.

Ee raatri. Terrace. Modati class.

RANI

Class of what?

Deni class?

VIKRAM

Sitting down.

Koorchovadam.

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

All liquor and cigarette brands to be fictional or de-branded labels. Ledger and SIM pouch are hero props for Scene 25 — lock their exact placement on the shelf and photograph. The unlit cigarette is a herbal prop. Statutory health warning cards to be added in post wherever smoking or drinking appears (CBFC requirement).

SCENE 10 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

Scene No.	10	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — table set by the rail with the skyline behind	Story day, date & time	Day 10 · Wed 18 June · 21:00–23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Warm-white fairy lights wound on the rail, 2 plastic chairs, folding table, tray: glasses (highball, rocks), steel bowl of ice, whisky bottle (de-branded; cold tea for liquid), soda bottles, limes, salt, jug of watermelon juice, mint leaves, cutting board and knife, black salt, rum and Coke (cola), vodka with orange juice, cigarettes (herbal) and Zippo, ashtray		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
10.1 The terrace has become a stage. Fairy lights from his event stock wound around the rail. Two plastic chairs. A small folding table with a tray: glasses, ice in a steel bowl, a bottle of whisky, soda, lime, salt, a jug of watermelon juice, mint leaves, a cutting board. CAMERA WIDE establishing, 24mm, from the terrace door: the set table, fairy lights, skyline. Detail inserts, 100mm, on the tray.	—

10.2 Rani steps out in her saree, uncertain. He pulls out her chair with exaggerated ceremony. CAMERA MS, 35mm, from behind the table: she steps into frame; he bows.	VIKRAM Madam, welcome to Club Penthouse. Membership: one. <i>Madam, club Penthouseeki svaagatam. Membarship: okkaru.</i> RANI Two. <i>Iddaru.</i> VIKRAM Two. <i>Iddaru.</i>
10.3 LESSON ONE: THE CIGARETTE. He lights one, shows her how to hold it — between two fingers, not like a pencil. She holds it like a pencil. He corrects her fingers. Their hands touch. She inhales far too deep and coughs like a dying tractor. He thumps her back. She coughs and laughs, eyes streaming. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: fingers holding the cigarette like a pencil, his fingers correcting. Two-shot, 50mm, for the coughing gag.	RANI This is what he liked? This is poison! <i>Ataniki nacchindi idaa? Idi visham!</i> VIKRAM Small puff. Hold it in your mouth only. Don't swallow the sky. <i>Chinna dammu. Notlone unchandi. Aakaasham mottam mingeyakandi.</i>
10.4 She tries again. Small puff. Lets it out slowly. Watches the smoke rise into the city light. Her face changes. Not pleasure in the cigarette. Pleasure in the watching. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, backlit so the smoke glows against the skyline; low angle.	RANI I'm sitting down. <i>Nenu koorchunnaa.</i> VIKRAM You're sitting down. <i>Meeru koorchunnaaru.</i>
10.5 LESSON TWO: THE PEG. He holds up a glass. CAMERA MCU Vikram, 50mm, holding the glass to the lights like a showman.	VIKRAM Small peg, thirty ml. Large, sixty. Patiala — that's for Punjabi weddings and broken hearts. Today we do small. <i>Small peg, muppai ml. Large, aravai. Patiyaalaa — adi panjaabee pellillaki, virigina gundelaki. Ee roju small maatrame.</i>

10.6 He pours. Shows her: ice first, then whisky, then soda down the side of the glass so it doesn't kill the fizz. CAMERA Top-down insert, 100mm: ice, whisky, soda poured down the side.	VIKRAM Whisky with soda — gentleman's drink. Whisky with water — uncle's drink. Whisky with Thums Up — college drink. Never with Sprite. That's a crime. <i>Whisky with soda — gentleman drink. Whisky with water — uncle drink. Whisky with Thums Up — college drink. Sprite-to maatram eppudoo vaddu. Adi neram.</i> RANI Who made these rules? <i>Ee rules evaru pettaaru?</i> VIKRAM Bartenders at three a.m. <i>Tellavaarujaamu moodinti bartenderlu.</i>
10.7 He moves through it like a performance. Rum with Coke and a lime wedge squeezed and dropped in. Vodka with orange juice. Then the non-alcoholic: watermelon juice, crushed mint, lime, a pinch of black salt, soda on top. CAMERA Quick insert series, 100mm, cut to rhythm: lime squeeze, orange pour, mint crushed, black salt pinch. Close on her delighted face between inserts, 85mm.	VIKRAM And this is for the nights you want to feel fancy but wake up fresh. Virgin watermelon mojito. <i>Idi — fancygaa feel avvaali, kaanee podduna freshgaa levaali anukune raatrulla kosam. Virgin watermelon mojito.</i> RANI Virgin. <i>Virgin.</i>
10.8 She repeats the word and covers her mouth, scandalised and giggling. He laughs too. CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm; both laughing.	VIKRAM That's what they call it! <i>Daanni alaage pilustaar!</i>
10.9 She sips the whisky soda first. Grimaces. Sips again. The grimace softens. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, for the grimace and its melting.	RANI It burns. <i>Mandutondi.</i> VIKRAM It's supposed to. Then it warms. <i>Mandaali. Tarvaata vecchagaa avutundi.</i>

10.10 She sips. Waits. Her hand drifts to her chest. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her hand drifting to her chest.	RANI It's warming. <i>Vecchagaa avutondi.</i>
10.11 LONG SEQUENCE, almost real-time. Two people on a terrace with the whole city glittering below them. She asks him about his childhood. He tells her about his father leaving when he was nine, about learning to cook Maggi at ten, about arriving in Hyderabad at nineteen with eight hundred rupees. Some of it is true. Some of it — we will later learn — is borrowed from other people's stories. CAMERA Two cameras: A-cam wide profile two-shot against skyline, 35mm; B-cam alternating CUs, 85mm. Dialogue here is improvised in Telugu by the actors within the beats given; capture 6–8 minutes, cut to ~3.	—
10.12 She tells him about the mango tree. The broom. That she was the one who told Ammamma he was the thief. CAMERA Continue B-cam singles, 85mm.	VIKRAM You snitched? <i>Meeru chaadeelu cheppaaraa?</i> RANI I was twelve. You were two. You had mango all over your face. <i>Appudu naaku pannendu. Meeku rendu. Moham nindaa maamidi rasam.</i>
10.13 A beat. The arithmetic of it hangs in the air. Twelve and two. Thirty-five and twenty-five. She looks away first. CAMERA Static wide two-shot, 35mm; hold the silence 4 seconds.	RANI I'm too old to be sitting here like this. <i>Ilaa ikkada koorchodaaniki naaku vayasu ekkuva.</i> VIKRAM Like what? <i>Elaa?</i> RANI Happy. <i>Santoshangaa.</i>
10.14 He refills her glass — only soda this time. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: soda only into her glass.	VIKRAM You didn't get to be twelve properly. Or twenty. Or thirty. So you get them now. All at once. That's the rule of Club Penthouse. <i>Meeku pannendellu sariggaa dakkaledu. Iravai koodaa. Muppai koodaa.</i> <i>Anduke ippudu annee okesaari dakkutaayi. Ade club Penthouse rule.</i>

10.15 She drinks the soda, eyes on him, and something unspoken passes. He breaks it with a joke. She lets him.

CAMERA CU Rani over the rim of the glass, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram. End on a wide of two small figures and the city, 24mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

All "alcohol" is non-alcoholic substitute (cold black tea for whisky/rum, water for vodka). Herbal cigarettes only; ventilated set. Skyline as real background: shoot at blue hour for the first half, then deep night. Fairy lights are the key practical; add a soft 1x1 LED for faces. Health-warning captions in post. Long sequence can be covered with two cameras to keep real-time rhythm.

SCENE 11 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NEXT MORNING **NEW · ROMANCE**

Scene No.	11 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom	Story day, date & time	Day 11 · Thu 19 June · 09:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5: grey cotton saree (slept in, rumpled) VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~4 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Breakfast tray: glass of lemon water, steel tumbler of buttermilk with salt and curry leaves, plate of two idlis with chutney; curtains (open, harsh sun), pillows, ceiling fan (practical, turning), Vikram's phone on bedside table		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
11.1 The First Hangover. Rani lies face-down on the bed, a pillow over her head, groaning at the sunlight. Vikram enters with a tray: lemon water, buttermilk with salt and curry leaves, two idlis. CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: Rani face-down, pillow over head, sun stripe across the bed. MS Vikram entering with tray, 35mm.	RANI (<i>muffled</i>) Close the curtains. Close the sun. Close Hyderabad. <i>Kartenlu veyandi. Sooryudini mooseyandi. Hyderabadni mooseyandi.</i> VIKRAM Congratulations. Your first hangover. <i>Kangraats. Mee modati hyaangovar.</i> RANI Is this what he felt every morning? And still he drank every night? <i>Ataniki rojoo podduna ilaage undedaa? Ayinaa rojoo raatri taagevaadaa?</i> VIKRAM Men are not very intelligent. <i>Magavaallaki telivi konchem takkuva.</i>

11.2 She laughs, then clutches her head because laughing hurts. CAMERA MCU Rani, 50mm, peeking out from under the pillow.	RANI Never again. I swear on Venkateswara Swamy. Never again. <i>Inkeppudoo taaganu. Venkateswara Swami meeda ottu. Inkeppudoo.</i> VIKRAM Everyone says that. Swamy has heard it a lakh times. <i>Andaroo ade antaaru. Swami laksha saarlu vinnaaru.</i>
11.3 He sits, props her up against his shoulder, and holds the lemon water to her lips. She drinks. He presses two fingers to her temples and massages slowly. Her eyes close. CAMERA Two-shot on the bed, 50mm, eye level. Insert, 100mm: fingers on her temples.	RANI Where did you learn this? <i>Idi ekkada nerchukunnaaru?</i> VIKRAM Amma. Every time Nanna came home drunk, she did this for him. After he left, she did it for me when I had fever. <i>Amma daggara. Naanna taagi vacchinappudallaa Amma ilaage chesedi. Aayana vellipoyaaka, naaku jvaram vacchinappudu naakoo chesedi.</i> RANI Ten more minutes. <i>Inko padi nimishaalu.</i> VIKRAM Of what? <i>Deniki?</i> RANI Your hand. Don't move it. <i>Mee cheyi. Teeyakandi.</i>
11.4 He doesn't. She drifts back to sleep with her head in his lap. He looks down at her. A long, quiet hold as the ceiling-fan shadow passes over them both. His phone buzzes on the bedside table. For once, he lets it ring out. CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: her head in his lap, fan shadow sweeping across both. Insert, 100mm: phone buzzing, unanswered, until it stops.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Bright, overexposed morning to sell the hangover: let the window blow out by 2 stops. Ceiling fan shadow is a hero element — position a hard source above the fan so its shadow sweeps across the bed. Keep the head-in-lap position modest and relaxed.

SCENE 12 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL — AFTERNOON

Scene No.	12	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, closed bedroom door, narrow hall	Story day, date & time	Day 13 · Sat 21 June · 15:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R6: blue jeans and sleeveless red top, barefoot, hair loose (enters in R2 green saree) VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Rani's steel trunk open on bed, sarees stacked, newspaper-wrapped jeans with shop tag, red top, Vikram's apple, his phone (camera app), Bluetooth speaker, Vikram's second phone on counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS

DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)

12.1 Rani's steel trunk is open on the bed. Under the sarees, wrapped in newspaper, a pair of blue jeans with the shop tag still on, and a sleeveless red top. Vikram, leaning on the door frame, eating an apple.

CAMERA Overhead insert, 50mm: newspaper unfolding to the jeans and tag. MS Vikram in doorway, 35mm.

VIKRAM

You've been hiding those for how long?

Vaatini ennaallugaa daachaaru?

RANI

Sravya bought them for me with her scholarship money. Last Diwali. She said, "Amma, you're not dead, you're divorced." I haven't worn them even once.

Sravya tana scholarship dabbulato konicchindi. Poyina Deepavaliki. "Ammaa, nuvvu chacchipoledu, vidaakulu teesukunnaav ante" andi. Okkasaari koodaa vesukoledu.

VIKRAM

Wear them.

Vesukondi.

RANI

Where? To go where?

Ekkadiki? Ekkadiki velladaaniki?

VIKRAM

To the hall. Then the terrace. Then the world.

Hall-loki. Tarvaata terraceki. Tarvaata prapanchanloki.

12.2 She pushes him out and closes the door. We stay outside with him. Long wait. He knocks.

CAMERA Hall side, 35mm: closed door, Vikram waiting. Hold for the long wait.

VIKRAM

Did you die?

Batike unnaaraa?

RANI (O.S.)

I can't do the button.

Batan pettalekapotunnaa.

VIKRAM

Need help?

Help kaavaalaa?

RANI (O.S.)

Don't you dare.

Lopaliki vaste choodandi!

12.3 The door opens. She stands there in the jeans and red top, arms crossed over herself, barefoot, hair loose for the first time in the film. She looks ten years younger and deeply uncomfortable. CAMERA Reveal from Vikram's POV as the door opens, 50mm, eye level; tilt down to bare feet and back up.	RANI Say something. No — don't say anything. <i>Edainaa cheppandi. Ledu — emee cheppakandi.</i>
12.4 He doesn't say anything. He just looks. The look goes on too long. She uncrosses her arms slowly. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; reverse CU Rani; insert of arms uncrossing.	VIKRAM Turn around. <i>Okasaari tiragandi.</i> RANI Why? <i>Enduku?</i> VIKRAM Phone photo. For Sravya. She paid for it, she should see. <i>Phone photo. Sravya kosam. Dabbu kattindi tane, tanu choodaali kadaa.</i>
12.5 That lands. She stands straighter. He takes the photo. Then another. Then he puts on a song from his speaker — an upbeat Telugu item number — and starts dancing badly to make her laugh. She refuses. He dances worse. She laughs and, finally, moves a little, swaying, embarrassed, then less embarrassed. CAMERA Phone-screen POV insert of the photo being taken. Handheld 35mm for the dance, moving with them.	—
12.6 They end up dancing in the narrow hall, bumping into the couch, laughing. The song ends. They are close. Breathing hard. Neither moves away. CAMERA Tight two-shot, 50mm, as the music stops; hold on breath.	—
12.7 His phone — the second one — buzzes on the counter. He doesn't look at it. For once, he doesn't look at it. CAMERA Rack focus: buzzing phone on counter (foreground) to the two of them (background), 85mm.	RANI <i>(quietly)</i> Send the photo to Sravya. <i>Photo Sravyaki pampandi.</i> VIKRAM Yeah. <i>Aa.</i>
12.8 He steps back. The moment passes. But it is now known to both of them. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: two figures stepping apart.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Wardrobe: jeans must be fitted for comfort and show the shop tag in the reveal (cut it off between takes per continuity log). Song for the dance must be cleared or composed; play back on set for rhythm. Keep the dance clumsy and joyful, not choreographed. Hair loose for the first time — note for hair continuity from here on.

SCENE 13 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	13	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 15 · Mon 23 June · 23:45 to dawn
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R6 : jeans and red top VIKRAM — Costume V4 : printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bed, single remaining pillow (the last of the wall), two empty glasses carried in, AC (practical), sheer curtain that lifts in the AC draft, window with city skyline		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS

13.1 After another terrace evening. Two glasses in. They come in from the terrace laughing about something we missed, a little unsteady. She is still in the jeans. They each go to their side of the bed. The pillow wall is down to one pillow now.

CAMERA Handheld follow from the terrace door into the bedroom, 35mm. Overhead, 24mm (matching Scenes 3 and 8): one pillow now.

13.2 Lights off. Blue city light. They lie on their backs. This is the only interior-monologue passage in the film. The voices are soft, overlapping, almost whispered, each one panned to its own side of the frame.

CAMERA Mattress-level profile two-shot, 50mm, both faces in frame; hold static through the inner voices. Very slow push-in over the whole passage.

DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)

—

RANI (V.O., inner)
Sleep, Rani. Close your eyes. He's a boy. He's Shanta-garu's son. You bathed him once. You —
Nidrapo Ranee. Kallu moosuko. Vaadu pillodu. Shanta gaari koduku. Okappudu vaadiki snaanam koodaa cheyinchavu. Nuvvu —

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)
Don't. Don't be stupid. She's here for a job. Two weeks. She'll go.
Vaddu. Picchipani cheyaku. Tanu udyogam kosam vacchindi. Rendu vaaraalu.

Vellipotundi.

RANI (V.O., inner)

He listened to me. Nobody has listened to me since my father died.

Atanu naa maata vinnaadu. Naannagaaru poyaaka naa maata evvaroo vinaledu.

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

She smells of coconut oil and whisky. That's — a terrible combination. Why is it working.

Tana daggara kobbarinoone, whisky vaasana vastondi. Adi — daarunamaina kaambineshan. Ayinaa enduku pani chestondi?

RANI (V.O., inner)

My hand is three inches from his hand. Three inches. I could move it by accident.

Naa cheyi atani chetiki moodu angulaala dooranlo undi. Moodu angulaalu. Porapaatuna kadilincheyocchu.

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

If she moves, I'll know. If she doesn't, I'll leave it.

Tanu kadilite, naaku arthamavutundi. Kadalakapote, vadilestaa.

RANI (V.O., inner)

What would Ammamma say.

Ammamma emantundi?

VIKRAM (V.O., inner)

What would Amma say.

Amma emantundi?

RANI (V.O., inner)

Ammamma drinks toddy on Sankranti.

Ammamma Sankrantiki kallu taagutundi.

13.3 She laughs out loud, a small snort in the dark. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: the two hands, three inches apart on the sheet. Then back to the profile two-shot.	VIKRAM <i>(aloud)</i> What? <i>Enti?</i> RANI <i>(aloud)</i> Nothing. <i>Em ledu.</i> VIKRAM <i>(aloud)</i> You laughed. <i>Navvaaru.</i> RANI <i>(aloud)</i> I was thinking about the toddy. <i>Kallu gurinchi aalochistunnaa.</i>
13.4 He laughs too. Then the laugh fades. Silence. The AC. The city. CAMERA Hold the two-shot; room tone only for 5 seconds.	RANI <i>(V.O., inner)</i> Now. If not now, never. You have waited your whole life for someone to ask. Nobody will ask. Ask. <i>Ippude. Ippudu kaakapote, inkeppudoo kaadu. Evarainaa adugutaarani jeevitamantaa eduruchooshaavu. Evvaroo adagaru. Nuvve adugu.</i>
13.5 She picks up the last pillow from between them. Holds it to her chest for a moment, like a shield. Then she drops it on the floor. CAMERA MS Rani sitting up with the pillow, 50mm. Insert, 50mm: pillow landing on the floor (the wall is gone).	—

13.6 He turns his head to look at her. She is looking at him. CAMERA Matched CUs on the pillows, 85mm, eye-line across the bed.	RANI <i>(aloud, barely)</i> Is this wrong? <i>Idi tappaa?</i> VIKRAM <i>(aloud)</i> Do you want it to be? <i>Tappu avvaalani meekundaa?</i> RANI I don't know what I want. Nobody has ever asked. <i>Naakem kaavaalo naake teliyadu. Evvaroo eppudoo adagaledu.</i> VIKRAM I'm asking. <i>Nenu adugutunnaa.</i>
13.7 A long, long beat. Her eyes fill. CAMERA ECU Rani's eyes, 100mm.	RANI Yes. <i>Avunu.</i>
13.8 He reaches across. Touches her face. She leans into his palm and closes her eyes, and a tear runs into his hand. He kisses her forehead first. Then she pulls him closer. CAMERA CU, 85mm: her face leaning into his palm; tear running into his hand. Forehead kiss in a tight two-shot. Cut away the moment she pulls him closer.	—
13.9 CUT TO: the window. The city lights. The curtain lifting in the AC draft. A slow, long hold on the skyline as a soft song begins — a romantic Telugu melody, female vocals. The sounds of the room are lost under the music. Time passes in light changes on the city: midnight, two a.m., the first grey of dawn. CAMERA Locked-off from inside the window, 35mm: curtain lifting in the foreground, skyline beyond. Dissolve into the time-lapse plate (midnight → dawn).	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

CLOSED SET. Intimacy coordinator present; modesty garments; actors consent to each beat before rehearsal. The scene cuts away at the forehead kiss and the pull closer; nothing further is filmed. Inner voices are recorded separately as whispered V.O. and panned L/R in the mix. Time-lapse of the skyline (midnight → dawn) shot as a separate plate from the bedroom window.

SCENE 14 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — MORNING

Scene No.	14	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, then the unlit stove	Story day, date & time	Day 16 · Tue 24 June · 07:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R5: grey cotton saree, hastily wrapped VIKRAM — Costume V3: white T-shirt, grey shorts		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Rumpled bedsheet, pillow on the floor (from Scene 13), cold stove, kadai, kitchen counter		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
14.1 Morning light. Rani wakes first. She sees where she is, sees him asleep beside her, and the full weight of it arrives. She sits up, pulling the sheet up, and stares at the floor. CAMERA CU Rani waking, 85mm, on the pillow. MS as she sits up, 50mm; her POV to the pillow on the floor.	—
14.2 She gets up quietly, wraps herself in a saree, goes to the hall, and stands at the stove without lighting it. Her shoulders start to shake. CAMERA Wide from the hall, 24mm: her back at the stove. Slow push-in to her shaking shoulders, 50mm.	—
14.3 Vikram wakes to an empty bed, finds her in the kitchen crying silently, her hand pressed to her mouth. CAMERA MS Vikram in bedroom doorway, 35mm; reverse onto her at the stove.	VIKRAM Rani. <i>Ranee.</i> RANI Don't. Don't come near. Let me — let me just — <i>Vaddu. Daggariki raakandi. Nannu — nannu kaasepu —</i>

14.4 He stops a few steps away.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 35mm, the gap between them held.

RANI

I'm thirty-five. I have a daughter almost your — not almost. She's twenty. You're twenty-five. What am I?

Naaku muppai aidu. Daadaapu mee vayasu — daadaapu kaadu. Naa kooturiki iravai. Meeku iravai aidu. Nenenti?

VIKRAM

You're a woman who had one good night.

Oka manchi raatri gadipina aadadi meeru.

RANI

I'm a mother.

Nenu oka tallini.

VIKRAM

You can be both.

Rendoo avvocchu.

RANI

In which village? In which family?

E oorlo? E kutumbanlo?

VIKRAM

In this house. You said this was home.

Ee intlo. Idi illu annaarugaa.

RANI

You said.

Annadi meeru.

14.5 She turns to face him. Her eyes are red.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eye level; single uninterrupted take for the speech.

RANI

He never — in twenty years he never once asked me. Not once. It was like — like a chore. Like sweeping. Last night you asked me three times if I was okay. Three times. I didn't know a man could ask. And now I'm standing here feeling like the dirtiest woman in Andhra Pradesh, and I don't know if it's because of what we did or because I liked it.

Atanu eppudoo — iravai ellalo okkasaari koodaa nannu adagaledu. Okkasaari koodaa. Adoka — panilaa. Illu oodchinattu. Ninna raatri meeru moodu saarlu adigaaru nenu baagunnaanaa ani. Moodu saarlu. Oka magaadu adagagaladani naaku teliyadu. Ippudu ikkada nilabadi Andhra Pradesh mottanlo nene ati muriki aadadaanni anipistondi. Adi manam chesinadaani vallaa, leka naaku adi nacchinandu vallaa — teliyatledu.

14.6 He crosses the distance. She lets him. He holds her face in both hands.

CAMERA Two-shot in profile, 50mm, as he crosses into her space; his hands frame her face.

VIKRAM

Listen to me. Nothing dirty happened in that room. You were taught that wanting is dirty. Your wanting is not dirty. Their hitting was dirty. Their dowry was dirty. You are the cleanest thing that has ever been in this flat — you literally cleaned it.

Naa maata vinandi. Aa gadilo muriki emee jaragaledu. Korukovadam muriki ani meeku nerpaaru. Mee korika muriki kaadu. Vaallu kottadam muriki. Vaalla katnam muriki. Ee flatlo ippativaraku unnavaatilo ati shubhramainadi meere — asalu deenni shubhram chesinde meeru.

14.7 She laughs through tears. Then cries harder. He pulls her into his chest. They stand in the kitchen, swaying slightly.

CAMERA Slow arc around the embrace, 35mm on slider.

RANI

What will we do?

Ippudem cheddaam?

VIKRAM

Breakfast. Then whatever you want.

Tiffin. Tarvaata meekem kaavaalante adi.

RANI

I don't know what I want.

Naakem kaavaalo naaku teliyadu.

VIKRAM

Then we'll find out. Every day, one thing.

Ayite kanukkundaam. Rojukokati.

14.8 She pulls back and looks at him, searching his face for a lie. She doesn't find one. That's the tragedy: there isn't one visible.

CAMERA Her POV on Vikram's face, 85mm, held a beat longer than comfortable.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Morning-after: flat, cool daylight (no sun yet). Intimacy coordinator to approve the waking frames; Rani wears a slip under the sheet. Her crying at the stove is silent: no music until the embrace. Keep the stove unlit as a visual note.

SCENE 15 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — LATE AFTERNOON

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	15 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — by the water tank, plastic chair	Story day, date & time	Day 17 · Wed 25 June · 17:00 to sunset
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree, hair loose VIKRAM — Costume V5: black hoodie, joggers		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Bottle of coconut oil warmed in the sun, plastic chair, small towel, hair comb, hair band for the braid		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
15.1 Oiling Her Hair. Rani sits on the terrace floor with a bottle of coconut oil warming in the sun. She is trying to oil her own hair and struggling to reach the back. CAMERA WIDE, 35mm, golden backlight; she is small against the water tank.	VIKRAM Give it. <i>Ivvandi.</i> RANI You don't know how. <i>Meeku raadu.</i> VIKRAM Teach me. Every day, one thing. <i>Nerpinchandi. Rojukokati anukunnaam kadaa.</i>
15.2 He sits on the plastic chair. She sits on the floor between his knees, her back to him. He pours far too much oil into his palm. She laughs. CAMERA Frontal two-shot, 50mm: her face in front, his behind and above. Insert, 100mm: oil overflowing his palm.	RANI Too much love drowns them. <i>Prema ekkuvaite munigipotaayi.</i> VIKRAM Plants. Not hair. <i>Adi mokkalaki. Juttuki kaadu.</i>

15.3 He works the oil into her scalp, clumsy at first, then gentler. She closes her eyes. CAMERA CU Rani's face, 85mm, eyes closing; his hands in soft focus in her hair.	RANI My father did this. Every Friday. Before school. He would sing while he did it. <i>Maa naannagaaru ilaa chesevaaru. Prati shukravaaram. Badiki vellemundu. Raastoo paadevaaru.</i> VIKRAM Ghantasala? <i>Ghantasala paatalaa?</i> RANI Always. The last time was the morning of my wedding. He oiled my hair, and his hands were shaking, and he didn't sing. I asked why. He said, "From tomorrow someone else will do this, Rani." Nobody did. Nobody ever did. <i>Eppudoo ave. Chivarisaari naa pelli roju podduna. Noone raashaaru, aayana chetulu vanukutunnaayi, paadaledu. Enduku ani adigaa. "Repati nunchi idi vere vaallu chestaarammaa" annaaru. Evvaroo cheyaledu. Eppudoo evvaroo cheyaledu.</i>
15.4 Her shoulders shake. He keeps oiling, slower now. Then, badly and off-key, he hums the Ghantasala tune she was humming in Scene 4. She cries and laughs at once. CAMERA Hold the frontal two-shot, 50mm; let the humming play in full.	RANI You're killing that song. <i>Aa paatani champestunnaaru.</i> VIKRAM I'm a mango thief. Not a singer. <i>Nenu maamidikaayala dongani. Singerni kaadu.</i>
15.5 He tries to braid her hair. It is a disaster, lopsided and loose. She feels it with her hand and laughs. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: clumsy fingers braiding; her hand feeling the lopsided result.	RANI Sravya did better braids when she was six. <i>Aarellappudu Sravya intakante baagaa jada vesedi.</i> VIKRAM Then I'll practise. Every Friday. <i>Ayite practice chestaa. Prati shukravaaram.</i>

15.6 She turns and looks up at him. Something in her face opens completely. CAMERA CU Rani looking up, 85mm, low angle; reverse CU Vikram looking down.	RANI Promise? <i>Promise?</i> VIKRAM Promise. <i>Promise.</i>
15.7 He bends and kisses the parting of her hair. She holds his wrist against her cheek. The sun sets behind the water tank. Hold on the two of them in silhouette. CAMERA Wide silhouette against the sunset and water tank, 35mm, locked off; hold 10 seconds.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Golden hour into sunset; the final silhouette against the water tank is the hero frame — schedule the last beat for the exact sunset minute. Real coconut oil on hair: hair department to wash and reset between takes (allow 40 minutes). The braid should be genuinely lopsided; continuity of braids continues in Scene 16.

SCENE 16 MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — DAYS AND NIGHTS

Scene No.	16	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — kitchen, bedroom, terrace; building parking lot seen from the terrace rail	Story day, date & time	Days 18–26 · 26 June – 4 July · various; birthday night Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 22:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R10: montage set (kurti with jeans, floral dress, shorts in bedroom only, rain-soaked chiffon saree); R7: Vikram's hoodie over nightie (dawn); R11: mustard cotton saree (birthday) VIKRAM — Costume V6: montage set (T-shirts, rain-soaked linen shirt, kurta for the birthday)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Pesarattu batter, tawa, burnt pesarattus; Royal Enfield in parking lot; red nail polish bottle; jasmine pot with first green bud; bedside lamp (to be knocked over, breakaway bulb); glasses; cigarette (herbal); Rani's phone; event fairy-light letters spelling HAPPY BIRTHDAY RANI (one letter flickering); small cake iced "RANI" with 36 candles; matchbox; knife and plate		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
16.1 A long montage over two songs, the first joyful, the second dreamy. The pillow wall is gone for good — we see it once, used as a backrest. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: the old pillow now propped as a backrest. Montage coverage mostly handheld 35mm with 85mm details.	—
16.2 Rani teaching Vikram to make pesarattu; he burns three; she eats the burnt ones. Vikram teaching her to ride the bike — no, just to sit on it in the parking lot of the building, which we only glimpse from the terrace rail; she screams with laughter when he revs it. She paints her toenails red on the bed, frowning in concentration. He paints one wrong and she smacks him with the bottle. Every Friday, a new lopsided braid — each one a little better. CAMERA Kitchen: two-shot at the tawa, 35mm. Bike: extreme high angle from the terrace rail looking down to the parking lot, 85mm compressed. Toenails: overhead insert, 100mm. Braids: a series of matched inserts of the back of her head, 50mm, one per Friday.	—

16.3 Rain on the terrace. They dance in it, she in a saree, soaked, hair stuck to her face, and he kisses her under the water tank. Her laughter echoes. The jasmine from Scene 5 shows its first green bud. CAMERA Rain towers; wide, 24mm, then 85mm under the tank for the kiss. Insert, 100mm macro: first green bud on the jasmine.	—
16.4 Nights: glasses on the bedside table, the bedside lamp clicked off by her hand — and then by his — and then the lamp knocked over and both of them laughing in the dark. Always the cut comes before anything is shown: a hand on a switch, the door pushed shut, the curtain falling. CAMERA Three matched inserts, 50mm: her hand on the lamp switch; his hand; the lamp tipping over. Black frames with laughter on the soundtrack.	—
16.5 She tries a cigarette alone on the terrace at dawn, wrapped in his hoodie, and holds it correctly now. She tries Western clothes one by one: a kurti with jeans, a dress he bought, a pair of shorts she refuses to wear past the bedroom door. In each, she is a little braver. CAMERA Dawn silhouette, 50mm, smoke catching first light. Wardrobe beats as a locked-off mirror shot, 35mm, same framing for each outfit (jump-cut).	—
16.6 A phone call. She takes it on the terrace, glowing. CAMERA MS Rani at the rail, 50mm; Vikram soft in the doorway behind.	SRAVYA (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Amma, who took that photo? You look like a heroine! Kiran says you look like you're twenty-five. <i>Ammaa, aa photo evaru teeshaaru? Heeroyinlaa unnaav! Nuvvu iravai aidella Ammaayilaa unnaavani Kiran antunnaadu.</i> RANI (<i>laughing, turning so Vikram can't see her blush</i>) A friend. A colleague. Study, Sravya. Fees are coming. <i>Oka friend. Koleeg. Chaduvuko Sravyaa. Fees vastundi.</i>
16.7 She hangs up. Vikram is watching her from the doorway. He is not smiling. He is thinking. Then the smile comes back, quickly. CAMERA Rack focus from Rani (foreground) to Vikram in the doorway, 85mm, catching the unsmiling beat.	—

16.8 THE BIRTHDAY. Night. Rani comes out of the bathroom and the hall is dark. A single candle. Then he switches on a string of lights spelling HAPPY BIRTHDAY RANI (event stock, one letter flickering). A small cake. Thirty-six candles crammed onto it. CAMERA Wide from the bathroom door, 24mm: dark hall, one candle; lights snap on. Insert, 50mm: the flickering letter.	RANI How did you know? <i>Meekelaa telisindi?</i> VIKRAM Your Aadhaar is on my laptop. You uploaded it to twenty-two job sites. <i>Mee aadhaar naa laptoplo undi. Iravai rendu job siteslo aplod cheshaarugaa.</i>
16.9 She stares at the cake. Her hand trembles. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, lit by the 36 candles.	RANI I have never had a cake. <i>Naa jeevitanlo eppudoo naa kosam cake ledu.</i> VIKRAM Never? <i>Eppudoonaa?</i> RANI In the village, birthday is temple and payasam. After marriage, nothing. I made cakes for my children every year. Never one with my name. <i>Oorlo puttinarojante gudi, paayasam. Pellayyaaka emee ledu. Prati edoo pillalaki cake cheshaa. Naa peruto okkati koodaa ledu.</i>
16.10 She crouches by the coffee table and reads the icing letter by letter, like a child reading. CAMERA Insert, 100mm, her finger moving under each iced letter. Low angle, 50mm, her face at cake height.	RANI R. A. N. I. <i>Aar. E. En. Ai. — Rani.</i>
16.11 She breaks down. Not from sadness. Something bigger. Thirty-six years of it. He kneels beside her and holds her while the candles drip wax onto the icing. CAMERA Two-shot on the floor, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: wax dripping onto the icing.	VIKRAM Make a wish before the cake catches fire. <i>Cake-ki nippu antukokamunde edainaa korukondi.</i>
16.12 She closes her eyes. Wishes. Blows. Misses half the candles. He blows the rest. CAMERA CU Rani, eyes closed, 85mm; two-shot as both blow.	VIKRAM What did you wish? <i>Em korukunnaaru?</i> RANI That this never ends. <i>Idi eppatikee mugiyakoodadani.</i>

16.13 On his face: a flicker. Something that might be guilt, or might be satisfaction. The candle smoke rises between them. Hold. Cut.

CAMERA CU Vikram through rising candle smoke, 85mm; hold 4 seconds; hard cut.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot as a 2-day montage block with a split unit (rain unit on terrace). Two songs (joyful, then dreamy) must be cleared or composed before shooting for rhythm. Bedroom beats always cut on a hand on a switch, a door or a curtain — intimacy coordinator present. Birthday cake: 3 identical cakes; candle wax fire-safety with extinguisher on set. The flickering letter is a practical fault built by art department.

SCENE 17

INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	17 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom	Story day, date & time	Day 26 · Fri 4 July · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R11 : mustard cotton saree, hair loose VIKRAM — Costume V6 : kurta from the birthday		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	2 — Awakening
Props & furniture	Plate of leftover birthday cake in the middle of the bed, cake crumbs, pillows (for the pillow fight), bedside lamp (low), soft rain outside the window		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
17.1 Antakshari Night. Later the same night. Leftover cake on a plate in the middle of the bed. Soft rain outside. They sit cross-legged facing each other, playing antakshari. CAMERA Symmetrical two-shot from the foot of the bed, 35mm; cake plate centred between them.	VIKRAM Your letter is "ma". <i>Mee aksharam "Ma".</i>

17.2 Rani closes her eyes and sings a few lines of an old Ghantasala-era melody (production to clear rights for the chosen song). Her voice is unexpectedly beautiful, low and sure. He stares at her.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, as she sings; cut to CU Vikram staring.

VIKRAM

You can sing. You can actually sing.

Meeru paadagalaru. Nijangaa paadagalaru.

RANI

In the village I sang at every wedding. After my own, I stopped.

Oorlo prati pellilo paadedaanni. Naa pellaayyaaka aapeshaa.

VIKRAM

Why?

Enduku?

RANI

He said a married woman singing loudly is calling men.

Pellayina aadadi gattigaa paadite magaallani pilichinatte annaadu.

VIKRAM

Then sing loudly. Call me.

Ayite gattigaa paadandi. Nannu pilavandi.

17.3 She laughs. His turn: he sings a recent dance number terribly, doing the hook step sitting down. She falls back on the bed laughing. Rounds pass in a quick sequence. He cheats; she catches him; a pillow fight scatters cake crumbs across the sheet.

CAMERA Handheld 35mm, loose and playful; jump-cut rounds. Overhead, 24mm, for the pillow fight and scattered crumbs.

—

17.4 Later. Lamp low. He lies with his head in her lap.

CAMERA Overhead, 35mm: his head in her lap, matching Scene 11 with roles reversed.

VIKRAM

Sing one more. Not a film song. Something only yours.

Inkoti paadandi. Sinimaa paata kaadu. Mee okkaride ayinadi.

RANI

There's a lullaby I sang to Sravya and Kiran. I made it up. Nobody else knows it.

Sravyaki, Kiranki nenu paadina jola paata okati undi. Nene kattaa.

Inkevvaree teliyadu.

VIKRAM

Then I'll be the third.

Ayite nenu moodovaadini avutaa.

17.5 She strokes his hair and sings, barely above a whisper. The lullaby is original to the film. CAMERA CU Rani looking down, 85mm, lamp-lit; insert of her fingers in his hair.	RANI <i>(singing)</i> Moonlight on the terrace, come down slowly. Bring sleep to my little life. <i>Meda meeda vennelaa, mellagaa digiraave. Naa chinni praanaaniki niddura</i> <i>tecchivvave.</i>
17.6 He falls asleep halfway through. She sings to the end anyway, very softly, looking down at his sleeping face. Her expression shifts: tenderness tipping into something close to fear of how much she feels. CAMERA Very slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, through to the end of the lullaby; hold her expression in silence after the last note.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The song Rani sings in the antakshari must be cleared or replaced with an original composition before the shoot; the lullaby is original to the film (music director to set the tune and record a guide). Live-record Rani's singing on set where possible. Pillow fight: feathers-free pillows.

SCENE 18 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — DAY / EVENING

Scene No.	18	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — counter and couch; Vikram's call on the terrace seen through the glass	Story day, date & time	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 09:00 (morning) and 18:30 (evening)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R2: green cotton saree (morning); R8: peacock-blue silk saree with zari border (evening) VIKRAM — Costume V4: printed casual shirt, chinos		
Screen duration (approx.)	~8 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Laptop with another rejection email, Vikram's second phone (job listing on screen), counter stools, couch, Rani's keypad phone, Rani's handbag, offer letter in an envelope (Serenity Wellness Spa letterhead — fictional)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
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18.1 Morning. Rani at the laptop, dejected. Another rejection. Vikram, freshly showered, scrolls his phone at the counter — the second phone.

CAMERA Two-shot across the counter, 35mm; Rani at laptop foreground, Vikram on stool behind. Insert, 100mm: the second phone in his hand.

VIKRAM

Wait. Wait, wait. Listen to this. "Serenity Wellness Spa, Jubilee Hills. Hiring female therapists. No experience needed. Training provided. Salary twenty-five thousand plus incentives. Accommodation optional."

Aagandi. Aagandi aagandi. Idi vinandi. "Serenity wellness spa, jooble hills. Mahilaa therapistulu kaavaali. Anubhavam avasaram ledu. Training istaam. Jeetam iravai aidu velu plas insentivs. Vasati aapshanal."

RANI

Spa? Like — massage?

Spanaa? Ante — massage-aa?

VIKRAM

Ayurvedic. Head massage, foot reflexology, body oils. Ladies only, it says. Five-star clients. Film people. Tips in thousands.

Aayurvedik. Head massage, foot reflexology, baadee aayils. Ladies maatrame ani undi. Five star clients. Sinimaa vaallu. Tips velallo.

RANI

I don't know massage.

Naaku massage raadu.

VIKRAM

You pressed Ammamma's legs every night for twenty years. You told me. That's ten thousand hours. That's an expert.

Iravai ellu prati raatri Ammamma kaallu nokkaaru. Meere cheppaaru. Ante padi vela gantalu. Adi eksparat level.

18.2 She laughs, doubtful. He is already dialling. He walks onto the terrace to talk. We stay inside with her. Through the glass, he is relaxed, laughing, too familiar with whoever is on the other end. She can't hear. We can, faintly.

CAMERA From inside, 50mm: Rani foreground soft, Vikram sharp through the glass door on the terrace. Hold; no cut outside.

VIKRAM *(O.S., muffled)*

Yes, Leela-akka, the one I told you about. ... Thirty-five, looks twenty-eight. ... Very shy. ... No, not yet. Slowly. ... Give me two weeks.

Avunu Leela akkaa, nenu cheppina aavide. ... Muppai aidu, iravai enimidilaa kanipistundi. ... Chaalaa siggu. ... Ledu, inkaa ledu. Mellagaa. ... Rendu vaaraalu time ivvu.

18.3 He comes back in, beaming.

CAMERA MS Vikram re-entering, 35mm.

VIKRAM

Interview tomorrow, eleven a.m. I'll drop you.

Repu podduna padakondintiki interview. Nenu draap chestaa.

RANI

Just like that?

Inta eejeegaanaa?

VIKRAM

I told you. Rich people need someone to arrange their happiness. Sometimes I arrange yours.

Cheppaanu kadaa. Dabbunnolla santoshaanni evaro okaru erpaatu cheyaali.

Appudappudu mee santosham koodaa nene erpaatu chestaa.

18.4 EVENING. The door opens. Rani rushes in, still in her best silk saree, glowing. She grabs his hands and spins him in a circle in the tiny hall.

CAMERA WIDE from the hall, 24mm, as the door bursts open. Handheld 35mm spin with them.

RANI

I got it! I got it! Twenty-five thousand! Madam Leela said I have "healing hands". She said I have a — a kind face. Training starts Monday!

Vacchesindi! Vacchesindi! Iravai aidu velu! Naavi "Heeling hyaands" ani Leela madam andi. Naadi — manchi moham andi. Somavaaram nunchi training!

18.5 He lifts her off the ground. She shrieks. He sets her down.

CAMERA Low angle two-shot, 35mm, as he lifts her.

RANI

Twenty-five thousand. Do you know what that is? Kiran's semester fee is forty-two. In two months — two months! — I can pay it myself. Not Ammamma's land. Not anyone's loan. Me.

Iravai aidu velu. Ante ento telusaa? Kiran semester fees nalabhai rendu velu.

Rendu nelallo — rende nelallo! — nene kattayocchu. Ammamma polam kaadu. Evari appoo kaadu. Nenu.

18.6 She sits on the couch, suddenly overwhelmed, and calls Ammamma. We hear the old woman's voice crackle.

CAMERA MCU Rani on the couch with the phone, 50mm.

AMMAMMA (V.O., on phone)

Job? Real job? Ammaa, Venkateswara Swamy heard me. Who got it for you? Udyogamaa? Nijamaina udyogamaa? Ammaa, Venkateswara Swami naa mora vinnaadu. Evaru ippinchaaru?

RANI (looking at Vikram)

Vikram. Shanta-garu's son.

Vikram. Shanta gaari abbaayi.

AMMAMMA (V.O.)

That mango thief? Tell him I'll make him pulihora when you come home. Tell him he's a good boy.

Aa maamidikaayala dongaa? Nuvvu intikocchinappudu vaadiki pulihora chesi pedataanani cheppu. Manchi pillodani cheppu.

18.7 Rani repeats it to him, laughing. Vikram smiles and looks away, out the window. Cut on his face.

CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, turning to the window; hard cut on his face.

RANI

You're a good boy.

Meeru manchi pillodata.

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The terrace phone call is played through the glass: record Vikram's side with a lav, mix it low and muffled so the audience only half-hears it. Spa name and letterhead are fictional; clear graphics. Evening light change between the two halves (practicals on, warm). Ammamma's V.O. recorded with a phone-filter treatment.

SCENE 19

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	19 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — dinner table under fairy lights	Story day, date & time	Day 29 · Mon 7 July · 21:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R8: peacock-blue silk saree (still in her best) VIKRAM — Costume V7: white linen shirt, sleeves rolled, dark jeans		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Fairy lights, folding table with white event tablecloth, 2 candles, chicken biryani in foil containers, single red rose in an empty (de-branded) beer bottle, handwritten board "CONGRATULATIONS, THERAPIST RANI", Vikram's phone playing music, plastic chairs		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
19.1 The Celebration Dinner. Rani steps out and stops. He has transformed the terrace: fairy lights, a folding table under a white event tablecloth, two candles, biryani in foil containers, a single rose standing in an empty beer bottle. A small handwritten board leans on the rail: CONGRATULATIONS, THERAPIST RANI. CAMERA Her POV reveal, 24mm, slow dolly forward. Insert, 50mm: the handwritten board; insert, 100mm: rose in the bottle.	RANI All this? For a job? <i>Idantaa? Oka udyogaanikaa?</i> VIKRAM For your job. Your first salary. Your name on an offer letter. <i>Mee udyogaaniki. Mee modati jeetaaniki. Aaphar letter meeda mee peruki.</i> RANI In my whole life, nobody has celebrated anything I did. When Sravya came first in the district, they celebrated Sravya. When I learned to read English bills, nobody even noticed. <i>Naa jeevitanlo nenu chesina dennee evvaroo celebrate cheyaledu. Sravyaki jillaa fast vacchinappudu Sravyani celebrate cheshaaru. Nenu ingleesh billulu chadavadam nerchukunnappudu evvaroo gamaninchanu koodaa ledu.</i> VIKRAM I noticed. <i>Nenu gamaninchaa.</i>

19.2 They eat with their hands from the same container. She feeds him a piece of chicken; he pretends it is too spicy and fans his mouth; she laughs. He plays an old romantic melody on his phone and holds out his hand.

CAMERA Two-shot across the table, 50mm, candles foreground. Insert, 100mm: her hand feeding him.

VIKRAM

Dance with me.

Naato daans cheyandi.

RANI

I don't know how. Not slow ones.

Naaku raadu. Ilaanti slow daansulu asalu raavu.

VIKRAM

Stand on my feet.

Naa kaalla meeda nilabadandi.

RANI

I'll break them.

Virigipotaayi.

VIKRAM

Then I'll limp happily.

Ayite santoshangaa kuntutaa.

19.3 She steps onto his feet, barefoot. They sway. She rests her forehead on his chest. The city glitters below.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: her bare feet stepping onto his. Slow 360° orbit on a track, 35mm, skyline wheeling behind them.

RANI *(softly)*

Vikram.

Vikram.

VIKRAM

Hm?

Oo?

RANI

Thank you. For the job. For everything. If not for you, I'd still be standing on Platform 14.

Thank-you. Udyogaaniki. Annitikee. Meeru lekapote neninkaa platform padnaalugu meede nilabadi undedaanni.

19.4 He holds her closer and does not answer. Over her shoulder, his face: a flicker of something unreadable. Then he closes his eyes and keeps dancing. The song plays out over the dark city.

CAMERA CU Vikram over her shoulder, 85mm, the unreadable flicker. Crane up and away to a high wide of the terrace and skyline, 24mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Warmest look of the film so far: fairy lights + candles as key, soft LED bounce for faces. Real biryani, eaten with hands; keep hand-wash station nearby. The slow dance with her feet on his: rehearse for balance; she is barefoot. Song must be cleared. Hold the final skyline frame for the song's last bar.

SCENE 20 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	20	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, bed and bedside table	Story day, date & time	Day 33 · Fri 11 July · 22:00
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R4: maroon cotton saree, hair tied up VIKRAM — Costume V8: bare back with a towel draped over it, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Spa training booklet (pressure-point diagrams, list of oils — fictional print), small bottle of coconut oil (rolls off the bed: practical), towel, bedside lamp, Vikram's second phone with message thread "L — Spa"		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
20.1 Rani has a training booklet from the spa: diagrams of pressure points, a list of oils. She sits on the bed reading it with her lips moving. Vikram lies face down on the bed with his shirt off and a towel over his back. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: booklet diagrams under her finger. MS two-shot, 35mm, from the foot of the bed.	VIKRAM Okay, therapist. Practise on me. <i>Sare therapist gaaroo. Naa meeda practice cheyandi.</i> RANI Practise on you? You're not a lady client. <i>Mee meedaa? Meeru ledee client kaadugaa.</i> VIKRAM Pressure points are the same. Backs are backs. <i>Pressure points andarikee okate. Veepu veepe.</i>

20.2 She warms coconut oil between her palms. Hesitates over his shoulders. Begins. She is good — genuinely, instinctively good, from twenty years of tired elders. He groans.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: oil warming between her palms; hands hovering. High-angle MS over his back, 50mm.

VIKRAM

Okay. Okay, you're actually good.

Sare. Sare, meeru nijangaa baagaa chestunnaaru.

RANI

Ammamma's knees.

Ammamma mokaalla punyam.

20.3 She works in silence for a while, reading the booklet propped beside her. Her technique improves as we watch. Then he starts coaching — and the coaching is not only about technique.

CAMERA CU Vikram's face on the pillow, 85mm, eyes open and thinking while he coaches.

VIKRAM

And talk to them. Clients like it when you talk. Ask their name. Compliment something. "Your skin is so soft, madam." They're lonely. Rich people are lonely.

Vaallato maatlaadandi koodaa. Maatlaadite clientski nacchutundi. Peru adagandi. Edo okati pogadandi. "Mee skin enta saaphtgaa undi madam." vaallu ontari vaallu. Dabbunnollu ontarigaane untaaru.

RANI

I can't say that with a straight face.

Adi serious mohanto cheppalenu.

VIKRAM

Try. On me.

Try cheyandi. Naa meede.

RANI *(giggling)*

Your skin is so soft, sir.

Mee skin enta saaphtgaa undi saar.

VIKRAM

Not funny. Serious. Low voice.

Navvu kaadu. Seriousgaa. Mellagaa.

RANI *(lower, trying)*

Your skin is so soft.

Mee skin enta saaphtgaa undi.

20.4 The giggle dies. She means it. The oil, the lamp, the closeness. He turns over slowly and looks up at her. The training booklet slides off the bed. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, as the giggle dies. Insert, 50mm: booklet sliding off the bed.	VIKRAM See? You make people feel things. That's the job. <i>Chooshaaraa? Meeru manushullo feelings kaligistaaru. Ade udyogam.</i>
20.5 She leans down and kisses him. The lamp is switched off by his hand. Cut to black on the sound of the oil bottle rolling off the bed and hitting the floor. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: his hand on the lamp switch. Black frame; sound of the bottle hitting the floor.	—
20.6 LATER. She is asleep. He is awake, sitting on the edge of the bed, texting on the second phone. The screen lights his face blue. A message thread with "L — Spa". We see his message, then it's gone: "Ready by month end. Trust me." CAMERA CU Vikram lit only by the phone, 85mm. Screen insert, 100mm: "Ready by month end. Trust me." Rack to Rani asleep, soft, behind him.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

CLOSED SET; intimacy coordinator present. Vikram is shot from the waist up on his back only; towel and track pants throughout. The scene cuts to black on the lamp switch. The phone message "Ready by month end. Trust me." is a screen insert (graphics), on screen for 2 seconds only.

SCENE 21 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT

Scene No.	21	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — couch in the dark; fridge with calendar; terrace and bathroom for the time-cut	Story day, date & time	Day 52 · Wed 30 July · 23:00 (time-cut runs to Day 59)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R9: spa uniform (lilac tunic and trousers) with handbag; R5 grey saree in the time-cut VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Wall calendar on fridge (dates crossed out; Kiran's fee date circled in red), spa uniform drying on terrace rail, row of oil bottles, framed photo of Sravya and Kiran on the shelf, Rani's handbag, glass with whisky-soda (cold tea), cash envelopes (prop currency, clearly marked), shower (bathroom) for the fully-clothed beat		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
21.1 Three weeks later. A calendar on the fridge has dates crossed out. The flat now has Rani's things everywhere: a spa uniform drying on the terrace rail, a row of oil bottles, a framed photo of Sravya and Kiran on the shelf. CAMERA Montage of inserts, 50–100mm: calendar, uniform on rail, oil bottles, framed photo.	—
21.2 Rani comes home late. Quiet. She doesn't switch on the light. She sits on the couch in the dark with her bag on her lap. Vikram comes out of the bedroom. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: only street light through the glass. MS Vikram in the bedroom doorway, 35mm.	VIKRAM Why are you sitting in the dark? <i>Cheekatlo enduku koorchunnaaru?</i> RANI Leela madam called me into her room today. <i>Ee roju Leela madam nannu tana roomki pilichindi.</i>

21.3 He sits. Waits. CAMERA Two-shot on the couch, 50mm, low key.	RANI She said the regular clients are happy. Very happy. She said some of the madams want — more. Extra. She said it's "relaxation service". Private room. Double the money. Triple with tips. <i>Regular clients happygaa unnaarata. Chaalaa happygaa. Kontamandi madamlaki — inkaa kaavaalata. Extra. "Relaxation service" antaarata. Private room. Double dabbu. Tipsto triple.</i> VIKRAM <i>(carefully neutral)</i> What kind of extra? <i>Elaanti extra?</i>
21.4 Rani can't say it. She looks at the floor. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, eyes down.	RANI The kind that — that ladies don't do with ladies. In our village. <i>Alaantidi — aadavaallu aadavaallato cheyanidi. Maa oorlo.</i>
21.5 A long silence. CAMERA Hold the two-shot, 50mm.	VIKRAM And what did you say? <i>Meeremannaaru?</i> RANI I said I'd think. I didn't want to lose the job. I came out and I was shaking at the bus stop. Why are you not angry? <i>Aalochistaanannaa. Udyogam pogottukovaalani ledu. Bayatikocchi bus stoplo vanikipoyaa. Meeku kopam enduku raavatledu?</i> VIKRAM Because I'm thinking. <i>Endukante nenu aalochistunnaa.</i> RANI Thinking what? She asked me to — with women — I'm not — <i>Em aalochistunnaaru? Aavida nannu — aadavaallato — nenu alaantidaanni kaadu —</i> VIKRAM Rani. Breathe. Come here. <i>Ranee. Oopiri teesukondi. Ilaa randi.</i>

21.6 He pours her a drink. Small peg, soda down the side of the glass. She takes it automatically. He sits beside her.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: soda poured down the side of the glass (exact echo of Scene 10). Two-shot, 50mm.

VIKRAM

Who are these women?

Evaru aa aadavaallu?

RANI

Rich. Lonely. Some husbands abroad, some husbands don't touch them. One cries during the head massage every time. She told me her husband hasn't looked at her in six years.

Dabbunnollu. Ontari vaallu. Kondari bhartalu videshaallo, kondari bhartalu vaallani muttukoru. Okaavida head massage chesina pratisaaree edustundi. Aarellugaa bharta tana vaipu choodaledani cheppindi.

VIKRAM

And you know what that feels like.

Adi elaa untundo meeku telusu.

21.7 She looks at him.

CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; reverse CU Vikram, 85mm, through the persuasion that follows (keep him half in shadow).

VIKRAM

Twenty years nobody asked what you wanted. These women are paying someone to ask. You're the one who knows how to ask. You learned it here. With me.

Iravai ellu meekem kaavaalo evvaroo adagaledu. Ee aadavaallu evarainaa adagaalani dabbu kadutunnaaru. Elaa adagaalo telisindi meeke. Ikkade nerchukunnaaru. Naato.

RANI

That was love.

Adi prema.

VIKRAM

And this is care. Paid care. Nurses touch bodies. Doctors touch bodies. Nobody calls them names. It's the same skin.

Idi sanrakshana. Dabbu teesukune sanrakshana. Narsulu ontini muttukuntaaru. Doctorlu muttukuntaaru. Vaallani evaroo tittaru. Ade charmam.

RANI

It's not the same.

Adi okati kaadu.

VIKRAM

It's not. It's better paid.

Kaadu. Deeniki dabbu ekkuva.

21.8 She almost laughs, then doesn't. He takes her hand.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: his hand taking hers.

VIKRAM

I'm not saying do it. I'm saying don't decide from your mother-in-law's mouth. Decide from yours. You said yes to me after thirty-five years of no. You know how to say yes now. You also know how to say no. Both are yours.

Cheyamani nenu cheppatledu. Mee attagaari notito nirnayinchakandi antunnaa. Mee notito nirnayinchandi. Muppai aidella "Vaddu" tarvaata naaku "Sare" annaaru. Ippudu "Sare" anadam meeku telusu. "Vaddu" anadam koodaa telusu. Rendoo meeve.

21.9 She drinks. Long silence. CAMERA Hold two-shot, 50mm.	RANI Kiran's fee is due in nineteen days. <i>Kiran fees kattadaaniki inkaa pantommidi rojule undi.</i> VIKRAM I know. <i>Telusu.</i> RANI How do you know? <i>Meekelaa telusu?</i>
21.10 The tiniest pause. CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm, one beat.	VIKRAM You crossed it on the calendar. In red. <i>Kyaalendar meeda erra pento maark cheshaarugaa.</i>
21.11 She looks at the calendar. It's true. She nods slowly. CAMERA Her POV: calendar on the fridge, red circle, 50mm push-in.	RANI Only ladies. <i>Ladies maatrume.</i> VIKRAM Only ladies. And if anything feels wrong, you walk out and call me. I'll be downstairs in fifteen minutes. Every time. <i>Ladies maatrume. Edainaa tappugaa anipiste, bayatikocchi naaku phone cheyandi. Padihenu nimishaallo kinda untaa. Pratisaaree.</i>
21.12 She leans her head on his shoulder. He strokes her hair. His eyes are open, fixed on the dark window, and his reflection in the glass looks like a different man. CAMERA Shoot into the dark terrace glass, 50mm: the couple in the foreground soft, Vikram's reflection in the glass sharp.	—
21.13 TIME CUT — a week of nights, a brief sequence. Rani coming home later and later. Cash in envelopes placed on the counter. The red circle on the calendar crossed out: PAID. She calls Kiran; we hear only his joyful voice from the phone. CAMERA Matched-frame sequence, 35mm locked off on the front door: she enters at later clock times (insert of wall clock). Insert, 100mm: envelopes on counter; "PAID" written over the red circle.	KIRAN (<i>V.O., on phone</i>) Amma, thank you! <i>Ammaa, thank-you!</i>

21.14 She cries happy tears on the terrace. She also, once, sits under the shower fully clothed for a long time. He watches from the doorway and says nothing.

CAMERA MS on the terrace, 50mm. Bathroom: high angle through the shower glass, 35mm, Rani clothed under the water; reverse on Vikram in the doorway, 85mm.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Prop money must be printed "FOR FILM USE ONLY". Calendar is a hero continuity prop through Scenes 21–28 (red circles, crossings, PAID): art department to keep a dated master. Shower beat: warm water, wardrobe double of R5, quick change and heater for the actor. Kiran's V.O. is one line, recorded with phone filter.

SCENE 22

INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — SUNDAY, RAIN ALL DAY

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	22 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 56 · Sun 3 August · 11:00–16:00 (rain all day)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R12 : Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas VIKRAM — Costume V9 : navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Tangled sheets, bowl of roasted peanuts, 2 cups of his tea, ballpoint pen (blue, skin-safe ink), rain on the window (rain bar outside)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
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22.1 A Sunday in Bed. The spa is shut. Rain on the window all day. A tangle of sheets, a bowl of roasted peanuts, two cups of his terrible tea. Rani in his oversized T-shirt and cotton pyjamas; neither of them has dressed properly. She lies with her head on his chest.

CAMERA Overhead, 24mm: two figures in tangled sheets, peanut bowl, tea cups; rain shadows on the sheet from the window.

RANI

Have you seen the sea?

Meeru samudram chooshaaraa?

VIKRAM

Goa. For an event. Why?

Govaalo. Oka event kosam. Enduku?

RANI

I have never seen it. Thirty-six years. Vizag is four hours from our village, and I have never seen the sea. He went every year with his friends.

Nenu eppudoo choodaledu. Muppai aarellu. Maa oori nunchi Vizag naalugu gantale, ayinaa samudram choodaledu. Atanu prati edoo friendsto vellevaadu.

VIKRAM

What do you think it looks like?

Adi elaa untundani anukuntunnaaru?

RANI

Like the terrace sky. But lying down. And moving. And never tired.

Mana terrace aakaashanlaa. Kaanee padukuni untundi. Kadulutoo untundi. Eppudoo alasipodu.

22.2 He takes a pen from the bedside table, opens her palm, and draws: a small house with a flat roof, a stick-figure plant on top, wavy lines in front.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro, top-down on her open palm as the ink house is drawn line by line.

VIKRAM

Our house. In Vizag. Beach Road. Terrace on top. Jasmine. And this — the sea. You'll wake up and the first thing you see is water.

Mana illu. Vizaglo. Beech road. Paina terrace. Malle mokka. Idi — samudram. Meeru levagaane modata neelle kanipistaayi.

RANI

And the children?

Mari pillalu?

VIKRAM *(adding tiny figures)*

Sravya's room. Kiran's room. Ammamma on the ground floor because of her knees.

Sravya room. Kiran room. Mokaalla valla Ammamma kinda floorlo.

22.3 She laughs, then looks at the drawing for a long time. CAMERA CU Rani looking at her palm, 85mm.	RANI Don't say things like this if you don't mean them. I'm too old to wash dreams off my hand. <i>Manasulo lekapote ilaanti maatalu anakandi. Cheti meedi kalalu kadukkune vayasu kaadu naadi.</i> VIKRAM Then don't wash it. <i>Ayite kadakkandi.</i>
22.4 She closes her fist around the ink drawing and holds it against her chest. She settles back against him. The rain goes on. A long hold on her closed fist. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her fist closing over the drawing, held to her chest. Long hold; rain sound only.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Soft, grey all-day light: large diffusion outside the window, rain bar on the glass. The palm drawing is done by make-up in skin-safe ink; photograph the drawing for continuity (faint smudge in Scene 32). Keep both actors fully clothed; relaxed, domestic intimacy only.

SCENE 23 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — NIGHT

Scene No.	23	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom: door, floor against the wall, the bed	Story day, date & time	Day 63 · Sun 10 August · 23:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R13: plum cotton saree, handbag VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt, track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Rani's handbag (thrown at wall — soft breakaway contents), bed, bedroom wall, door that slams		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
23.1 Rani storms in, slams the door, throws her bag at the wall. Vikram sits up in bed. CAMERA WIDE from the bed, 24mm: door slams, bag hits wall. Quick insert of bag contents spilling.	RANI Men. <i>Magaallu.</i> VIKRAM What? <i>Enti?</i> RANI Men! Leela madam says from next week, men also. "Couples' packages" first, she says, then "gentlemen only". She says the money is five times. She says the girls who said no are gone. She says she'll give my slot to someone younger. <i>Magaallu! Vacche vaaram nunchi magaallu koodaa antondi Leela madam. Mundu "Kapuls packages", tarvaata "Gentlemen only" anta. Dabbu aidu retlu anta. Vaddanna Ammaayilu ippudu lerata. Naa slaat inkevarainaa chinna pillaki icchestaanantondi.</i>

23.2 She is pacing. CAMERA Handheld MS following her pacing, 35mm.	RANI I said I'm not that kind of woman. You know what she said? She laughed. She said, "Vikram said you'd say that." <i>Nenu alaanti aadadaanni kaadannaa. Aavidemando telusaa? Navvindi. "Nuvvu alaage antaavani Vikram munde cheppaadu" andi.</i>
23.3 Silence. He goes very still. CAMERA Locked-off CU Vikram, 85mm; the handheld energy stops dead.	RANI Why does she know your name? <i>Aavidaki mee peru elaa telusu?</i> VIKRAM <i>(smoothly)</i> Because I'm the one who called her for the interview. Everyone in this industry knows everyone. I do her events. Her Diwali party. Her spa launch. <i>Endukante interview kosam phone chesindi nene. Ee indastreelo andarikee andaroo telusu. Aavida events nene chestaa. Deepavali party. Spa laanch.</i> RANI And you told her what I'd say? <i>Nenemantaano aavidaki meeru cheppaaraa?</i> VIKRAM She asked what you're like. I said you're a good woman who will say no to everything at first. Because you were trained to. I said it as a compliment. <i>Meerelaanti vaallani adigindi. Modata pratidaanikee "Vaddu" ane manchi manishi ani cheppaa. Endukante meeku alaage nerpaaru. Pogadtagaane cheppaa.</i>

23.4 She stares at him, wanting to believe it. She does believe it. That is what we are watching: her deciding to believe it.

CAMERA Slow push-in on Rani, 85mm, across 6 seconds of silence.

RANI

I won't do it.

Nenu cheyanu.

VIKRAM

Then don't.

Ayite cheyakandi.

RANI

Then I lose the job.

Appudu udyogam potundi.

VIKRAM

Then you lose the job.

Ayite ponivvandi.

RANI

And Sravya's final-year fee, and the hostel, and Kiran's laptop, and Ammamma's knee surgery —

Mari Sravya final year fees, hostel, Kiran laptop, Ammamma mokaali operation —

VIKRAM

I know.

Telusu.

23.5 She sits on the floor against the wall. Puts her face in her knees.

CAMERA High angle, 35mm, Rani small against the wall.

RANI

Why does every road in my life end at a man's body?

Naa jeevitanlo prati daaree oka magaadi onti daggare enduku mugustundi?

23.6 He sits on the floor beside her. Doesn't touch her yet.

CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm, both against the wall.

VIKRAM

You know what the difference is? Before, men took. Your husband took. His family took. Now you set the price. You decide. You walk out with the money. That's not the same road. That's the opposite road.

Tedaa ento telusaa? Intaku mundu magaallu laakkunnaaru. Mee bharta laakkunnaadu. Atani kutumbam laakkundi. Ippudu retu meeru nirnayistaaru. Meere nirnayistaaru. Dabbuto meeru bayatiki nadustaaru. Adi ade daari kaadu. Poortigaa eduru daari.

RANI

It looks the same from the inside.

Lopala nunchi chooste rendoo okelaa untaayi.

23.7 He has no answer for that. For a long time, neither speaks. Then, softly:

CAMERA Hold the floor two-shot; 8 seconds of silence.

VIKRAM

If you want, we'll practise. So it's not strange. So nothing surprises you. So you're the one in control.

Meeku kaavaalante practice cheddaam. Vintagaa anipinchakundaa. Edee shaak ivvakundaa. Kantrol mee chetilo undelaa.

RANI

Practise what?

Em practice?

VIKRAM

How to say no to the things you don't want. How to stop a man's hand without making him angry. How to keep your face calm. How to end a session. I've watched a hundred of these men at events. I know how they talk. Let me be them. You handle me.

Meeku ishtam lenidaaniki "Vaddu" elaa anaalo. Kopam raakundaa oka magaadi chetini elaa aapaalo. Moham prashaantangaa elaa unchaalo. Session elaa muginchaalo. Eventlalo ilaanti vandala mandini chooshaa. Vaallu elaa maatlaadataaro telusu. Nenu vaallalaa untaa. Meeru nannu hyaandil cheyandi.

23.8 She looks at him. Long, searching. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm.	RANI You'd do that? Pretend to be one of them? <i>Meeru alaa chestaaraa? Vaallalo okarilaa natistaaraa?</i> VIKRAM I'd do anything to keep you safe. <i>Mimmalni safegaa unchadaaniki emainaa chestaa.</i>
23.9 PRACTICE SESSION. This is played as a disturbing role-play, not as romance. He sits on the bed and becomes a client: loud, entitled, pushy. CAMERA Cold top light switches on. Low angle on Vikram as "client", 35mm, making him loom.	VIKRAM <i>(as client)</i> How much for the full service, madam? <i>Full serviceeki enta madam?</i>
23.10 She freezes. He drops character. CAMERA CU Rani frozen, 85mm.	VIKRAM Breathe. Say the menu. Say no to what's not on it. <i>Oopiri teesukondi. Menoo cheppandi. Menoolo lenidaaniki "Vaddu" anandi.</i>
23.11 Again. She tries, voice trembling. Again. Steadier. He grabs her wrist as the client. She panics. He drops character, calms her, teaches her to twist free and smile. Again. Again. She gets better. Each round, she is less herself. CAMERA Repetition in matched frames, 50mm, jump-cutting between rounds. Insert, 100mm: his grip on her wrist (the grip that returns in Scene 26). Her face grows more composed and emptier each round.	—
23.12 At the end she is shaking, and he holds her, and the role-play dissolves into the two of them again. She clings to him as if he is the only safe body in the city. The camera pulls back, slowly, through the bedroom door, into the dark hall, until they are small in the frame. Cut. CAMERA Dolly pull-back, 35mm, from the embrace through the doorway into the dark hall; 20-second move; cut.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The role-play is staged as disturbing, not romantic: cold, flat top light, no score. Intimacy and stunt coordinators to choreograph the wrist-grab and twist-free; padded wristband under the sleeve. CLOSED SET. No physical contact beyond what is rehearsed. Final pull-back through the doorway on a dolly.

SCENE 24 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN

Scene No.	24	INT / EXT	EXT / INT
Location	Penthouse terrace rail; bedroom through the glass door; bathroom door	Story day, date & time	Day 64 · Mon 11 August · 05:45
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R7: Vikram's grey hoodie over cotton nightie VIKRAM — Costume V9: navy T-shirt (asleep)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	3 — The Offer
Props & furniture	Cigarette (herbal) and lighter, Rani's phone, terrace rail (cigarette stubbed out on it), bed, bathroom tap (running at full force)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
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24.1 Rani alone on the terrace in his hoodie, a cigarette held properly now. Her phone rings. Sravya.

CAMERA Profile MS at the rail, 50mm, dawn sky behind; insert, 100mm: phone screen "Sravya".

SRAVYA (*V.O., on phone*)

Amma, are you sleeping? Sorry, sorry. I couldn't wait. The college sent the final-year notice. Placement training fee, exam fee, and the industrial tour — total is one lakh eighteen thousand. By the fifteenth. I'm sorry, Amma. I'll do tuitions. I'll —

Ammaa, nidrapotunnaavaa? Sorry sorry. Aagalekapoyaa. College final year notees pampindi. Placement training fees, egjaam fees, indastriyal tour — mottam lakshaa paddenimidi velu. Padiheno taareekhu lopu. Sorry Ammaa. Nenu tuitionlu cheptaa. Nenu —

RANI

Don't do tuitions. Study.

Tuitionlu vaddu. Chaduvuko.

SRAVYA (*V.O.*)

You sound tired.

Alasipoyinattunnaav.

RANI

City air.

City gaali.

SRAVYA (*V.O.*)

Amma — are you happy there?

Ammaa — akkada nuvvu santoshangaa unnaavaa?

24.2 Rani looks back through the glass door. Vikram asleep on the bed, one arm flung over her empty side.

CAMERA Her POV through the glass door, 85mm: Vikram asleep, arm across her empty side.

RANI

I'm — something. I'll pay it. By the tenth. Don't worry.

Nenu — edolaa unnaa. Kattestaa. Pado taareekhu lopu. Kangaaru padaku.

24.3 She hangs up. Smokes the cigarette down to the filter. Stubs it out on the rail. Goes inside. Shakes Vikram awake.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: cigarette stubbed on the rail. Handheld follow inside, 35mm.

RANI

Tell Leela madam yes.

Leela madamki sare ani cheppandi.

24.4 He opens his eyes. Doesn't smile. Nods. She walks into the bathroom and shuts the door. We hear the tap run, full force, to cover something. Hold on him alone in the bed — and then, very slowly, the corner of his mouth lifts. Cut.

CAMERA Locked-off CU Vikram on the pillow, 85mm; hold through the tap sound until the corner of his mouth lifts; hard cut.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Dawn: shoot the call in the 20 minutes before sunrise; cool blue ambience, no fill. Sravya's V.O. recorded with phone filter. The final hold on Vikram's mouth lifting is the act-ending image: lock off, let the tap sound run under it.

SCENE 25 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT

Scene No.	25	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom (wardrobe panel), hall, front door and dark corridor	Story day, date & time	Day 67 · Thu 14 August · 23:20–23:50
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R14: faded orange cotton saree VIKRAM — Costume V10: towel at waist after shower, hair wet		
Screen duration (approx.)	~15 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Vikram's second phone (message preview graphic), the ledger (hero prop: dated pages, two columns "L" and "V", crossed-out names, Rani's page with weekly entries in changing ink colours), rubber band, plywood panel, bed pulled out, Rani's steel trunk, sarees, jeans, red top, framed photo of Sravya and Kiran, Rani's purse, front door, rain in the corridor/stairwell		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
25.1 Vikram is in the shower. His second phone rings on the bed. Once. Twice. Rani, folding clothes, glances at it. "L — Spa". It stops. A message preview slides in: "Rani's Saturday booking confirmed. Hotel, room 412. Client paid 40 advance. Your 60% as usual. Good work, Vikku." CAMERA MS Rani folding clothes, 35mm, phone in the foreground buzzing. Insert, 100mm: caller ID, then the message preview (screen graphic, held long enough to read).	—
25.2 She reads it again. Again. She does not understand the words, and then she understands all of them at once. Her hand goes cold on the phone. CAMERA ECU, 100mm: her eyes reading the screen, left-right, again. CU of her hand going still on the phone.	—
25.3 She goes to the wardrobe. Pulls the bed out. Opens the plywood panel. Takes out the ledger book with the rubber band. Sits on the floor and opens it. CAMERA Handheld, 35mm, urgent: bed dragged, panel pulled. Low angle from inside the hidden shelf as her hand reaches for the ledger (callback to Scene 9).	—

25.4 INSERT: pages of names — only first names, women's names — with dates, amounts, two columns: "L" and "V". Some names crossed out. Some with notes: "village", "widow", "husband abroad", "runaway". And on the most recent page, in his neat handwriting, her name. RANI. The first entry is the date she arrived. Note beside it: "Arrived. Very shy. Divorced. Two kids, fees. No family in city. 4–6 weeks." CAMERA Top-down inserts, 100mm macro, page by page; slow pan along a column of names. Stop on RANI and the arrival date.	—
25.5 She turns the page. Under her name, line by line, the weeks of her life: "Week 1 — trust. Cleaning, cooking. Let her talk." "Week 2 — drinks. Smoking. Freedom talk." "Week 3 — physical. Make her feel wanted." "Week 4 — L interview. Ladies first." "Week 6 — men. Practice. Kids' fees = lever." CAMERA Insert, 100mm: each line revealed as her finger moves down; ink colour visibly changing line to line. Intercut CU Rani reading, 85mm.	—
25.6 The shower stops. She doesn't move. He comes out in a towel, hair wet, whistling. Sees her on the floor with the book. The whistle dies. CAMERA Wide from the bathroom door, 24mm: Rani on the floor with the ledger in the foreground; Vikram enters background and stops.	—
25.7 A silence so long the AC sounds deafening. CAMERA Hold the wide; AC hum raised in the mix.	RANI <i>(very quietly)</i> "Kids' fees equals lever." <i>"Pillala fees samaanam lever."</i>

25.8 He doesn't speak. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, frozen.	RANI What is a lever, Vikram? I studied till ninth class. Explain it to me. <i>Lever ante enti Vikram? Nenu tommido taragati varaku chadivaa. Naaku arthamayyela cheppu.</i> VIKRAM Rani, put that down. <i>Ranee, adi kinda pettu.</i> RANI A lever is something you use to move a heavy thing that won't move by itself. Physics. Eighth class. I remember. My children are your lever. <i>Tanantata taanu kadalani baruvaina daanni kadilinchadaaniki vaadedi lever. Physics. Enimido taragati. Gurtundi. Naa pillalu nee lever.</i>
25.9 She stands up. The book in her hand. CAMERA Low angle, 35mm, as she rises into frame holding the ledger; he is now smaller.	RANI "Arrived. Very shy." The first day. Before I even came inside. Before you said "feel like home". You wrote this the first day. <i>"Vacchindi. Chaalaa siggu." modati roje. Nenu lopaliki raakamunde. "Mee illu anukondi" anakamunde. Modati roje idi raashaavu.</i> VIKRAM I wrote it later. <i>Tarvaata raashaa.</i> RANI The ink is different every week! You wrote it every week! While I was cooking for you, you were writing the next week! <i>Prati vaaram inku veregaa undi! Prati vaaram raashaavu! Nenu neeku vandi pedutunte, nuvvu tarvaati vaaram em cheyaalo raasukuntunnaavu!</i>
25.10 She throws the ledger at him. It hits his chest and falls open on the floor. CAMERA Two-shot, 35mm; insert of the ledger landing open on the floor (soft-weighted dummy).	RANI Who are you? <i>Asalu nuvvevaru?</i>

25.11 And now, for the first time, he stops performing. He picks up the ledger, closes it, puts the rubber band back on. Calm. That calm is the most frightening thing in the film. CAMERA Static MS, 50mm, eye level; let the calm action play in real time. Insert, 100mm: rubber band snapped back on.	VIKRAM You know who I am. I'm the one who listened. Everything I said was true. <i>Nenevaro neeku telusu. Nee maata vinnavaadini. Nenu cheppindantaa nijame.</i> RANI You're a — a — <i>Nuvvu oka — oka —</i> VIKRAM Say it. Pimp. It's just a word. Event manager is also just a word. I arrange people's happiness. That part was never a lie. <i>Aney. Brokar. Adi oka maata ante. Event manager koodaa oka maate. Nenu janam santoshaanni erpaatu chestaa. Aa maata eppudoo abaddham kaadu.</i>
25.12 She slaps him. Hard. His head turns. He turns it back slowly. Doesn't touch his cheek. CAMERA Two-shot in profile, 50mm, cheat angle for the stunt slap. CU Vikram turning his head back, 85mm.	VIKRAM Your husband hit you for twenty years and you never hit back once. You told me. Look at you now. Who taught you that? <i>Nee bharta iravai ellu kottaadu, nuvvu okkasaari koodaa tirigi kottaledu. Nuvve cheppaavu. Ippudu ninnu choodu. Idi evaru nerpaaru?</i>
25.13 She slaps him again. He lets her. CAMERA Same profile two-shot; second slap.	RANI Did you — did you feel anything? Any night? The birthday? The cake? <i>Neeku — neekemainaa anipinchindaa? E raatranaa? Puttinaroju? Aa cake?</i>
25.14 For the first time, he hesitates. CAMERA Tight CU Vikram, 85mm; hold the hesitation.	VIKRAM The cake was real. <i>Aa cake nijam.</i> RANI The cake was a lever. <i>Aa cake koodaa oka lever.</i> VIKRAM The cake was real. <i>Aa cake nijam.</i>

25.15 She stares at him. She cannot tell. Neither can we. She runs to the bedroom, pulls out her steel trunk, throws sarees into it, the jeans, the red top — no, she throws the red top across the room. Kiran and Sravya's photo from the shelf. She drags the trunk to the door. He doesn't stop her. He leans on the counter and watches.

CAMERA Handheld, 35mm, chaotic packing. Insert: red top thrown across the room. Wide from the counter, 24mm: Vikram foreground still, Rani dragging the trunk to the door.

25.16 She has her hand on the door handle.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hand on the door handle. MS Vikram at the counter, 50mm, for the speech (one take, no push).

VIKRAM

Where will you go?

Ekkadiki veltaavu?

VIKRAM

It's eleven forty at night. Raining. You have eleven hundred rupees in your purse — I know because I know. The last bus to your village left at nine. Your bank account has the spa salary, which is Leela's account, which she can freeze tomorrow. Sravya's fee is due on the fifteenth. You'll call Ammamma and say what? "The good boy who got me a job sold me"? She'll have a heart attack. You'll tell Sravya? She'll leave college to work in a mall. Kiran will drop out. That's what you'll go to.

Raatri padakondudu nalabhai. Varsham padutundi. Nee parsulo padakondudu vandalu unnaayi — naaku telusu, endukante naaku telustundi. Mee ooriki last bassu tommidintike vellipoyindi. Nee byaank akauntlo unnadi spa jeetam, adi Leela akaunt, repe freeze cheyagaladu. Sravya fees padihenu taareekhu. Ammammaki phone chesi em cheptaavu? "Udyogam ippinchina aa manchi pillodu nannu ammeshaadu" anaa? Aavidaki gundepotu vastundi. Sravyaki cheptaavaa? College maanesi maallo paniki veltundi. Kiran chaduvu aapestaadu. Nuvvu velledi akkadike.

25.17 Her hand stays on the handle. It is shaking. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: the shaking hand on the handle.	VIKRAM Or you stay. One booking. Saturday. Forty thousand. I'm not lying about the money. That's Sravya's fee in one night. One night, and she becomes the first woman in your family to finish a degree. You'll be the reason. <i>Ledaa ikkade undu. Okka booking. Shanivaaram. Nalabhai velu. Dabbu vishayanlo abaddham cheppatledu. Okka raatrilo Sravya fees. Okka raatri, mee kutumbanlo digree poorti chesina modati aadapilla avutundi. Daaniki caranam nuvve.</i> RANI You'll make me the reason for this? <i>Deeniki nannu caranam chestaavaa?</i> VIKRAM I'm making you the reason for her. <i>Tanaki caranam chestunnaa.</i>
25.18 She turns the handle. Opens the door. The corridor outside is dark; the rain is loud from the stairwell. She stands on the threshold — half in, half out — for a very long time. Hold it. Thirty seconds. Forty-five. CAMERA From the dark corridor looking in, 35mm: Rani framed in the doorway, half lit by the flat, half dark. Locked off; hold 45 seconds, rain sound up.	—
25.19 She shuts the door. Leans her forehead against it. Slides down to the floor, crying without any sound at all. CAMERA Inside, 50mm: she slides down the door into a low frame; no sound but room tone.	—

25.20 Vikram comes and sits on the floor beside her. He doesn't touch her. Then he does: his hand on her back, exactly where she showed him the kick landed. She flinches. Then she leans into him. She hates herself for it. She leans anyway. CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: his hand landing on the exact spot on her lower back (match to the Scene 8 insert).	RANI <i>(whispering)</i> I hate you. <i>Ninnu dveshistunnaa.</i> VIKRAM I know. <i>Telusu.</i> RANI I hate you. <i>Ninnu dveshistunnaa.</i> VIKRAM I know. Hate me tomorrow. Tonight, sleep. <i>Telusu. Repu dveshinchu. Ee raatriki paduko.</i>
25.21 He lifts her. She lets him carry her to the bed. That is the horror of the scene: she lets him. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, from the terrace door: he carries her across the hall into the bedroom; hold on the empty doorway after.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The most important dialogue scene in the film: block on day 1, shoot on day 2 with two cameras. Ledger pages designed by art department in Vikram's handwriting, inks visibly different week to week; on-screen text must be legible in inserts. Slaps are choreographed by the stunt coordinator (camera-side cheat, sound added in post). Towel safety: Vikram changes into V9 navy T-shirt off camera after the first exchange if the director prefers. The 30–45 second hold at the open door must play in full — no cutaway. From this scene on, Telugu dialogue drops from "meeru" to "nuvvu".

SCENE 26 INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM / BATHROOM / HALL — SATURDAY NIGHT

Scene No.	26	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — wardrobe mirror, empty hall, bathroom door; terrace at dawn	Story day, date & time	Day 69 · Sat 16 August · 19:30 → 02:50 → dawn 05:50
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R15: black sheer georgette saree, gold-tone necklace, heels, evening purse; after return R14 towel wrap (modest framing) VIKRAM — Costume V11: dark bomber jacket over black shirt, car keys		
Screen duration (approx.)	~12 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Wardrobe mirror, necklace, small purse containing: a phone with one saved number, lipstick, condoms (packaging only, de-branded), pepper spray; her half-finished cup of tea on the counter, toothbrush, framed photo of the children, wall clock (practical, hands set per time-cut), fridge, a lizard (VFX or trained), envelope thick with prop cash, dry towel, terrace at dawn		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
26.1 EVENING. The bedroom. Rani at the wardrobe mirror in a black saree he has bought — sheer, expensive. He stands behind her, fastening a necklace, like a husband before a wedding. Her face in the mirror is completely blank. CAMERA Mirror shot, 50mm: both faces in the wardrobe mirror, his hands at her neck. Her face dead centre, blank.	VIKRAM You look — <i>Nuvvu</i> — RANI Don't. <i>Vaddu.</i>

26.2 He stops. He hands her a small purse. Inside: a phone with one number saved, a lipstick, condoms, a pepper spray. CAMERA Top-down insert, 100mm: purse opened, contents shown.	VIKRAM Room 412. If anything — anything — you press this and I'm in the lobby in four minutes. I'll be there all night. In the car. <i>Room naalugu vandala pannendu. Edainaa — edainaa sare — idi nokku, naalugu nimishaallo laabeelo untaa. Raatrantaa akkade untaa. Carlo.</i> RANI In the car. Waiting. Like a driver. <i>Carlo. Eduruchoostoo. Draivarlaa.</i> VIKRAM Like a bodyguard. <i>Baadeegaardlaa.</i> RANI Like a shopkeeper waiting for the cash. <i>Dabbu kosam eduruchoose dukaanadaarudilaa.</i>
26.3 She walks out of the frame. The door closes. We do NOT follow her. The camera stays in the empty flat. Real time slows to a crawl. Her cup of tea, half finished, on the counter. Her toothbrush. The photo of her children. The clock: nine. Ten. Eleven. Midnight. One. The fridge hums. A lizard crosses the wall. Two. This passage should be almost unbearable. CAMERA Locked-off still-life plates, 35–50mm, each held 6–10 seconds: tea cup, toothbrush, photo, wall clock at each hour, lizard on the wall. No camera movement at all.	—
26.4 2:50 A.M. A key in the lock. Rani comes in alone. Her saree is wrinkled; the pallu is held over one shoulder with her fist. Her lipstick is gone. There is a red mark on her wrist. She walks past the couch, past the kitchen, straight into the bathroom without turning on a light. Locks the door. CAMERA Wide master from the hall, 24mm, same frame as the still-lives; she crosses it in one move. Insert, 100mm: red mark on her wrist as she passes.	—
26.5 The shower turns on. Full force. Vikram enters a minute later — he followed her up from the car. He stands at the bathroom door. CAMERA MS Vikram at the bathroom door, 50mm, door in frame.	VIKRAM Rani. <i>Ranee.</i>

26.6 Nothing. The water. CAMERA Hold.	VIKRAM Rani, open. <i>Ranee, talupu teeyi.</i>
26.7 Nothing. CAMERA Hold.	VIKRAM Did he hurt you? <i>Vaadu ninnu baadhapettaadaa?</i>
26.8 From inside, a sound that is not quite crying — a deep, animal sound, muffled by a towel. CAMERA Sound only; CU Vikram's face against the door, 85mm.	—
26.9 He slides down the bathroom door and sits on the floor outside it. The water runs. Twenty minutes in real screen time compressed to four. Finally the lock clicks. She comes out in a towel, skin scrubbed red, hair dripping. She sees him on the floor. CAMERA Low angle from the floor, 35mm, Vikram against the door; dissolves to show time passing. Door opens above him; Rani framed from the shoulders up.	RANI He wanted me to call him "husband". <i>Vaadini "Emandee" ani pilavamannaadu.</i>
26.10 She says it flatly. Then she laughs — a terrible laugh. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, hair dripping.	RANI Twenty years with a husband, and the first stranger also wants a husband. He held my wrist like this. Like him. Exactly like him. The same grip. All men have the same hands, Vikram. Did you know that? Same hands. <i>Iravai ellu oka bhartato, modati paraayivaadiki koodaa bharta kaavaalata.</i> <i>Naa manikattu ilaa pattukunnaadu. Atanilaa. Accham atanilaa. Ade pattu.</i> <i>Magaallandarikee oke chetulu Vikram. Neeku telusaa? Oke chetulu.</i>
26.11 She holds out the envelope. Thick with cash. Drops it on the floor between them. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: envelope dropping to the floor between their feet.	RANI Count it. You're the accountant. <i>Lekkapettu. Akauntentvi nuvve kadaa.</i>

26.12 He doesn't touch it. He stands, takes a dry towel, and starts drying her hair, very gently, the way she once wiped his face. She stands rigid.

CAMERA Two-shot, 50mm, eye level; his hands in her hair, her body rigid.

VIKRAM

That one was bad. That's my fault. Leela didn't screen him. I'll never send you to him again. Next time I'll choose. Myself. Gentlemen only. Educated. Married men who just want to talk. Some of them just want to talk, Rani. I swear.

Vaadu cheddavaadu. Tappu naade. Leela vaadini sariggaa check cheyaledu. Inkeppudoo vaadi daggariiki pampanu. Eesaari nene select chestaa. Nene. Gentlemen maatrame. Chaduvukunnavaallu. Kevalam maatlaadaalanukune pelayina magaallu. Kondaru kevalam maatlaadaalane anukuntaaru Rane. Ottu.

RANI

Next time.

Eesaari.

VIKRAM

I promise. Good customers next time.

Promise. Eesaari manchi customerlu.

26.13 She turns around and looks at him. Her face crumples. She collapses into his chest, sobbing, beating her fist weakly on his shoulder with every word.

CAMERA Tight two-shot, 85mm; her fist on his shoulder in frame.

RANI

Why — do — I — still — come — to — you?

Inkaa — nee — daggarike — enduku — vastunnaa?

VIKRAM

Because I'm the one who's here.

Endukante ikkada unnadi nenokkadine.

26.14 He holds her as she cries. The cash envelope sits on the floor between their feet, untouched. Fade.

CAMERA Tilt down from the embrace to the envelope on the floor, 35mm; fade.

—

26.15 DAWN, SAME NIGHT. She is asleep — or pretending. He sits on the terrace, counts the cash under the grey light. Divides it into two piles. Puts the larger pile in his pocket. Then — after a long hesitation — takes two notes from his pile and adds them to hers. We don't know if that is love or accounting.

CAMERA Terrace at blue dawn, 50mm; insert, 100mm: counting hands, two piles, two notes moved across. End on CU Vikram, 85mm, unreadable.

—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The empty-flat passage (9 p.m. to 2:50 a.m.) is the key unbearable sequence: shoot locked-off plates of each object with the clock reset per shot; real time, no music. The customer is never seen or heard. Red mark on her wrist by make-up (matches the grip in Scene 23). Towel wrap: modest framing, closed set, intimacy coordinator present. Prop cash marked "FOR FILM USE ONLY".

SCENE 27

INT. PENTHOUSE — BEDROOM — LATE MORNING

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	27 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — bedroom, bed and chair beside it	Story day, date & time	Day 70 · Sun 17 August · 10:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R12: Vikram's oversized black T-shirt and cotton pyjamas VIKRAM — Costume V11: last night's black shirt, jacket off, red polish on fingertips		
Screen duration (approx.)	~5 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Red nail polish bottle on the bedside table, chair beside the bed, sheet, sunlight through the window		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
27.1 Painted Toes. Rani wakes late into sunlight. She feels something cool on her feet and looks down. Her toenails have been painted red, carefully, every one of them neat. The bottle stands on the bedside table. Vikram is asleep in the chair beside the bed, still in last night's clothes, red polish on his fingertips. CAMERA CU Rani waking, 85mm. Her POV down the bed to her feet, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: neatly painted toes; insert: polish bottle; wide to include Vikram asleep in the chair, 35mm.	—

27.2 She stares at her feet. Then at him. Her eyes fill. He wakes.

CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm.

VIKRAM

I didn't go wrong this time. Not even one.

Eesaari okkati koodaa tappu cheyaledu. Okkati koodaa.

RANI

Why?

Enduku?

VIKRAM

You used to do it every Sunday. You stopped. Two weeks now. I noticed.

Prati aadivaaram vesukunedaanivi. Aapshaav. Rendu vaaraalaindi. Nenu gamaninchaa.

RANI

You notice everything. That's your job.

Nuvvu annee gamanistaav. Ade nee udyogam.

VIKRAM

This one wasn't the job.

Idi udyogam kaadu.

27.3 She looks at him for a long time. She wants to believe it. She draws her knees up and touches one red toenail with her fingertip, as if it were precious.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: fingertip touching one red toenail.

RANI

When I was small, Ammamma said a woman's feet should never touch dirt, because Lakshmi lives in them. After marriage I walked barefoot on a cow-dung floor for twenty years. Last night I walked into that hotel in heels you bought. And this morning a man painted my feet like they are worth something. I don't know which of these is the lie.

Chinnappudu Ammamma cheppedi, aadadaani paadaalu mattini taakakoodadu, vaatilo Lakshmi untundani. Pellayyaaka iravai ellu peda alikina nela meeda cheppullekunda nadichaa. Ninna raatri nuvu konna heelsto aa hotelloki nadichaa. Ee podduna oka magaadu naa paadaalaki viluva unnattu rangi veshadu. Veetilo edi abaddhamo teliyatledu.

VIKRAM *(quietly)*

Maybe none. Maybe all.

Edee kaakapovacchu. Annee kaavacchu.

27.4 He sits on the edge of the bed. She doesn't pull away. He takes her foot in his hands and blows on the polish to dry it. She laughs once, wetly, despite herself: it is the burnt finger from Scene 7, in reverse. She lets her head fall back on the pillow and closes her eyes. Her hand finds his hair. Hold.

CAMERA Static two-shot, 85mm, matching Scene 7's framing: his face at her foot, her face on the pillow. Hold to the end.

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Make-up: Rani's toenails painted neatly red (every nail), Vikram's fingertips smudged red. Warm, soft sunlight — the first gentle light after the dark scenes. Blowing on the polish mirrors Scene 7: match the framing (static 85mm).

SCENE 28 MONTAGE — INT./EXT. PENTHOUSE — WEEKS

Scene No.	28	INT / EXT	INT / EXT
Location	Penthouse — fridge calendar, kitchen, terrace, front door, hall floor	Story day, date & time	Days 71–110 · 18 August – 26 September · various nights and afternoons
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R16: dark-phase montage set (shawl over printed nightie; muted synthetic sarees; black saree variation) VIKRAM — Costume V11: bomber jacket (booking nights); V9: navy T-shirt (home)		
Screen duration (approx.)	~10 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Fridge calendar (Saturdays circled → Wednesdays and Saturdays → nearly every day), steel tiffin box on top shelf with prop cash, Rani's phone with bank app (transfer screens: SRAVYA (FEES), KIRAN (LAPTOP), AMMAMMA (KNEE SURGERY)), takeaway containers piling up, cleaning supplies, shawl, cigarettes (herbal), whisky bottle and water jug (watering down), box of sweets, glass (breakaway sugar glass) to shatter against the fridge, broom and dustpan, tissue, ledger on counter with a new name page		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
28.1 A long, grim mirror of the Scene 16 montage. Same angles, same rooms, different life. One song: a slow, aching female melody. CAMERA Re-use Scene 16 frame grabs as the blocking reference for every set-up.	—
28.2 The calendar on the fridge: Saturdays circled, then Wednesdays and Saturdays, then almost every day. Cash going into a steel tiffin box on the top shelf. Rani at the bank app on her phone: transfers to SRAVYA (FEES), KIRAN (LAPTOP), AMMAMMA (KNEE SURGERY). Each transfer, she closes her eyes. CAMERA Locked-off calendar insert, 50mm, dissolving through the weeks. Insert, 100mm: cash into the tiffin box. Screen inserts for each transfer; CU Rani closing her eyes, 85mm.	—
28.3 She stops cooking. Takeaway containers pile up. The flat slowly returns to the mess of the first day — and then she cleans it all in one furious night at four a.m., and the cycle starts again. CAMERA Same wide master as Scene 2 (24mm from the front door) as a time-lapse of mess building; then handheld 35mm for the furious 4 a.m. clean.	—

28.4 She smokes more. Alone on the terrace in the afternoons, wrapped in a shawl even in the heat. She drinks larger pegs; he notices and quietly waters the bottle down. She notices that too. CAMERA Same dawn-rail frame as Scene 16, now harsh afternoon, 50mm. Insert, 100mm: water poured into the bottle; CU Rani noticing, 85mm.	—
28.5 COMING HOME, VARIATIONS. A night she comes home laughing: CAMERA Front-door locked-off, 35mm, repeated for each variation (matching the Scene 21 time-cut frame).	RANI He only talked about his ex-wife for two hours and cried. <i>Rendu gantalu tana maajee bhaarya gurinche maatlaadi edchaadu ante.</i>
28.6 A night she comes home with a bruise on her arm and says nothing. A night she comes home and immediately throws up in the sink. A night she comes home with a box of sweets a client gave her and stares at it like it's an insult. CAMERA Same front-door frame for each entry; inserts, 100mm: bruise; sink; box of sweets.	—
28.7 Each time, Vikram: drying her hair, pressing her feet, making her a virgin mojito, holding her while she cries, promising. His promises become a rhythm, like a prayer. CAMERA Repeated inserts, 50mm, of the same gestures from earlier scenes (towel in hair, feet, mojito pour). His voice overlaps across cuts.	VIKRAM Better ones next time. That's the last time with him. This month, only regulars. <i>Eesaari inkaa manchivaallu. Vaadito ade last. Ee nela regulars maatrume.</i>

28.8 FIGHTS. In the hall at three a.m.:

CAMERA Handheld two-shot, 35mm, harsh overhead tube light.

RANI

You took sixty percent of that night. Sixty! For sitting in a car!

Aa raatri aravai shaatam nuvvu teesukunnaav. Aravai! Carlo koorchunnanduku!

VIKRAM

For finding him, checking him, bribing the hotel, paying Leela, paying the police beat constable every month so you don't get picked up in a raid. You think safety is free?

Vaadini vetikinanduku, check chesinanduku, hotelki lancham icchinanduku, Leelaki icchinanduku, raidlo ninnu pattukokundaa beat constableki nelanelaa icchinanduku. Safety freegaa vastundanukunnaavaa?

RANI

Safe? You call this safe?

Safe-aa? Deenni safe antaavaa?

VIKRAM

You're alive. You're paid. You're home by four. Ask the girls on the highway what safe means.

Batike unnaav. Dabbu vastondi. Naalugintikallaa intlo untunnaav. Highway meeda unde Ammaayilni adugu safe ante ento.

28.9 She throws a glass. It shatters against the fridge. He sweeps it up silently. She watches him sweep, then gets down and helps, and they both cut their fingers on the same shard, and laugh — a mad, broken laugh — and bleed into the same tissue. And then they are in each other's arms again on the kitchen floor, and the cut comes before anything more.

CAMERA Sugar-glass shatter at 120fps, 35mm. Floor-level two-shot, 50mm; insert, 100mm: two bleeding fingertips on one tissue. Cut away as they embrace.

—

28.10 PHONE CALLS, intercut, voices only. CAMERA Rani on the terrace, MS 50mm, phone to ear.	AMMAMMA (V.O.) Rani, the doctor says the surgery went well. They're asking who paid. I told them my granddaughter works in a big spa in Hyderabad. They're all jealous. <i>Ranee, operation baagaa jarigindani doctor cheppaadu. Dabbu evaru kattaarani adugutunnaaru. Naa manavaraalu Hyderabadlo pedda spalo pani chestundani cheppaa. Andarikee kullu.</i> KIRAN (V.O.) Amma, the new laptop is so fast! Everyone in the hostel is asking. I told them my mother is a manager! <i>Ammaa, kotta laptop chaalaa fast! Hostello andaroo adugutunnaaru. Maa Amma manager ani cheppaa!</i>
28.11 Rani on the terrace, phone to her ear, smiling for the voices, her face wet. Vikram behind the glass, watching her. In one shot, through the glass, we see him with his own phone: a new name in the ledger on the counter. Someone else's first entry. "Arrived. Very shy." CAMERA From the terrace looking in, 50mm: Rani foreground (smiling, wet face); through the glass, Vikram at the counter with the open ledger, background only — readable but never inserted.	—
28.12 She doesn't see it. Or she sees it and turns away. The film lets us wonder. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; her eyes flick toward the glass, or don't — let the actor choose per take; director to pick in the edit.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Mirror Scene 16 shot-for-shot (same angles and lenses) so the audience feels the reversal. Bruise and cut-finger make-up; sugar-glass breakaway for the thrown glass; the shared shard is a rubber prop with a blood-capsule effect. Bank-app screens are generic graphics. Phone V.O.s (Ammamma, Kiran) recorded with phone filter. Final ledger insert ("Arrived. Very shy.") must be visible through the glass only in the background — do not cut to an insert.

SCENE 29

EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — NIGHT

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	29 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — jasmine pot and water tank	Story day, date & time	Day 112 · Sun 28 September · 21:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R17 : her late mother's red silk saree, jasmine garland, turmeric-yellow thread VIKRAM — Costume V12 : plain white cotton kurta and pyjama		
Screen duration (approx.)	~7 min	Movement	4 — The Reveal
Props & furniture	Jasmine plant in full white bloom (hero pot from Scene 5; greens dept), sewing thread and needle from Rani's trunk, two jasmine garlands (made on camera + pre-made doubles), yellow puja thread rubbed with turmeric, turmeric powder, fairy lights strung over the water tank as a canopy, cooler box (phones dropped in, lid shut), Vikram's two phones		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
29.1 The Fairy-Light Wedding. A rare night with no booking. Rani stands at the jasmine from Scene 5. It has finally flowered; white buds cover it. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: jasmine flowers in full bloom (match the bud insert from Scene 16). MS Rani at the pot, 50mm.	RANI It flowered. Fifteen days, I said. It took months. <i>Poosindi. Padihenu rojulannaa. Nelalu pattindi.</i> VIKRAM Late is not never. <i>Aalasyam ante eppatikee raadani kaadu.</i>

29.2 She plucks the flowers one by one into her palm. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: flowers gathering in her palm.	RANI Vikram. Give me one night. <i>Vikram. Naaku okka raatri ivvu.</i> VIKRAM For what? <i>Deniki?</i> RANI One night where we're normal. No phone. No Leela. No ledger. You're just a man and I'm just a woman and we're — married. Just pretend. One night. <i>Manam maamoolu manushullaa unde okka raatri. Phone vaddu. Leela vaddu. Ledjar vaddu. Nuvvu oka magaadivi, nenu oka aadadaanni, manaki — pelayindi. Natinchu chaalu. Okka raatri.</i>
29.3 He looks at her. He takes out both phones, switches them off, drops them into the cooler box, and shuts the lid. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: both phones switched off and dropped into the cooler box; lid shut.	VIKRAM Done. <i>Ayipoyindi.</i>
29.4 MONTAGE over a soft song. He untangles the fairy lights and strings them over the water tank like a wedding canopy. She goes inside and returns in her mother's old red silk saree, the one wedding thing she brought from the village. She threads two garlands from the jasmine with sewing thread from her trunk. He finds a yellow puja thread in an event kit and rubs it with turmeric from the kitchen. CAMERA Montage coverage, 35mm handheld and 100mm inserts: lights strung; her reveal in the red silk saree (slow dolly, 50mm); needle threading jasmine; turmeric rubbed into the thread.	—
29.5 They stand facing each other under the lights. No priest, no guests. Only the city. CAMERA Symmetrical wide two-shot under the canopy, 24mm, skyline behind.	VIKRAM I don't know the mantras. <i>Naaku mantraalu raavu.</i> RANI Nobody listens to the mantras. Say what you mean. <i>Mantraalu evaroo vinaru. Manasulo unnadi cheppu.</i>

29.6 A long pause. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm, searching for words.	VIKRAM I'll ask. Every time. Whether you're okay. Every single time. <i>Adugutaa. Pratisaaree. Nuvvu baagunnaavaa ani. Prati okkasaaree.</i>
29.7 That undoes her. Tears run down her face. She puts her garland on him; he puts his on her. He ties the yellow thread around her neck — three knots, fumbling. She laughs through her tears at his clumsiness and finishes the third knot herself. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, tears. Two-shot, 50mm, garlands exchanged. Insert, 100mm: fumbling knots; her fingers finishing the third.	RANI Seven steps. <i>Edu adugulu.</i>
29.8 They walk around the water tank, her pallu knotted to the hem of his kurta, counting aloud in Telugu: one, two, three, four, five, six, seven. At seven, she stops. CAMERA Steadicam circling with them around the water tank, 24mm, fairy lights streaking. Insert, 100mm: pallu knotted to his hem.	RANI & VIKRAM <i>(counting together)</i> One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. <i>Okati, rendu, moodu, naalugu, aidu, aaru, edu.</i> RANI The first time, I was thirteen. I didn't know what the steps meant. I was counting so I wouldn't cry. This time I'm counting so I remember. <i>Modatisaari naaku padamoodellu. Aa adugulaki artham ento teliyadu. Edavakundaa undataaniki lekkapettaa. Eesaari gurtunchukovadaaniki lekkapedutunnaa.</i>
29.9 They sit on the terrace floor, garlanded, under the lights. She rests her head on his shoulder. CAMERA Low wide two-shot from the floor, 35mm, fairy-light canopy above.	RANI Tomorrow you'll switch the phones on. <i>Repu phonelu aan chestaav.</i> VIKRAM Tomorrow. <i>Repu.</i> RANI Tonight I'm a wife who was asked. <i>Ee raatriki, adigi chesukunna bhaaryani nenu.</i>
29.10 He kisses her temple. Jasmine, fairy lights, the city. Hold for a long time. Through the glass door behind them, on the kitchen counter, the ledger sits exactly where he left it. Cut. CAMERA Slow push-in past them toward the glass door, 50mm, until the ledger on the counter inside is sharp in the background. Cut.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

The visual peak of the romance: fairy-light canopy over the water tank, jasmine flowers real and fresh (replace every 2 hours). Mangalsutra-style knots are symbolic only — no priest, no fire, no religious idols; consult a cultural adviser for respectful staging. Seven steps around the water tank must be clear of cables. The ledger visible through the glass in the final frame is a background element only.

SCENE 30 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — NIGHT, RAIN

Scene No.	30	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — front door, hall floor, couch	Story day, date & time	Day 118 · Sat 4 October · 23:50 → 03:00 (storm, power cut)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R18: printed chiffon saree with dupatta over her head, soaked through VIKRAM — Costume V2: grey vest, black track pants		
Screen duration (approx.)	~15 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Vikram's laptop (screen is the only light), couch, front door, rain in the doorway (water rig), towels off camera, no candles (deliberate contrast with Scene 8)		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
30.1 Rain again. The same storm as Scene 8 — deliberately echoed: thunder, then the power cut. But this time there are no candles. Vikram is on the couch with his laptop, the screen the only light. Rani comes in soaked, a dupatta over her head, no umbrella. She stands dripping in the doorway. CAMERA Same locked-off wide as Scene 8, 24mm; laptop glow on Vikram's face. Rani silhouetted in the doorway by lightning.	—
30.2 She isn't hurt this time. Not visibly. She is something worse: calm. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm, water running off her face, expression still.	RANI He was nineteen. <i>Vaadiki pantommidellu.</i>

30.3 Vikram looks up. CAMERA CU Vikram, laptop-lit, 85mm.	RANI Tonight's client. Nineteen. His friends paid for him. A birthday gift. He was shaking more than me. He kept calling me "aunty". He said "Sorry, aunty". "Is this okay, aunty." Kiran is nineteen. <i>Ee roju client. Pantommidellu. Vaadi friends dabbu kattaaru. Bartde gipht anta. Naa kante vaade ekkuva vanikipotunnaadu. "Aantee" ani pilustoone unnaadu. "Sorry aantee" annaadu. "Idi okenaa aantee" annaadu. Kiranki koodaa pantommide.</i>
30.4 She sits down on the floor, right where she is, in her wet clothes. CAMERA High angle, 35mm: Rani on the floor in a pool of rainwater.	RANI I told him to go home. I sat with him for two hours and he told me about his exams and his mother. I gave him water. I told him to study. When he left, he touched my feet. He touched my feet, Vikram. <i>Intiki vellipo ani cheppaa. Rendu gantalu vaadito koorchunnaa, vaadi egjaams gurinchi, vaallamma gurinchi cheppaadu. Neellu icchaa. Chaduvuko ani cheppaa. Veltoo naa kaallaki dandam pettaadu. Naa kaallaki dandam pettaadu Vikram.</i>
30.5 She starts to laugh, and it turns into crying halfway through, and then back to laughing, and she can't stop either. CAMERA Hold CU Rani, 85mm, one take.	RANI Leela will cut my share because he "didn't get his money's worth". <i>"Vaadiki dabbuku tagga service dakkaledu" ani Leela naa vaataa kat chestundi.</i>

30.6 Vikram closes the laptop. Dark. Only lightning now.

CAMERA Insert, 50mm: laptop closing; frame goes black; lightning flashes reveal both.

VIKRAM

I'll talk to Leela.

Leelato nenu maatlaadataa.

RANI

No. Listen to me. For once, you listen and I talk. Like the first rain. You remember the first rain?

Vaddu. Naa maata vinu. Okkasaarainaa, nuvvu vinu, nenu maatlaadataa.

Modati varshanlaa. Modati varsham gurtundaa?

VIKRAM

I remember.

Gurtundi.

RANI

That night you said I left exactly on time. The day the children were safe.

Aa raatri nuvvannaav, nenu sariggaa samayaanike vadilesaanani. Pillalu safe ayina roje.

30.7 She gets up on her knees and crawls to the couch, sits at his feet, takes his hands. Pleading. The posture of a devotee.

CAMERA Low angle from floor level, 35mm: Rani at his feet, Vikram above on the couch.

RANI

I want to leave on time again. Please. Please, Vikram. You know everyone in this city. You arranged a spa in one phone call. Arrange a decent job. Anything. Cook in a hotel kitchen. Housekeeping. Receptionist. I'll learn computer. I'll sweep floors. I'll take twelve thousand. Ten. Just let me come home and look at my children's photo without turning it face down.

Mallee samayaanike vadileyaalanundi. Please. Please Vikram. Ee oorlo neeku andaroo telusu. Okka phoneto spa erpaatu cheshaav. Oka manchi udyogam erpaatu cheyi. Edainaa sare. Hotel kichenlo vanta. Hauskeeping. Receptionist. Kampyootar nerchukuntaa. Nelalu oodustaa. Pannendu velu chaalu. Padi velu. Intikocchi naa pillala photoni borlaa tippakundaa choosukonivvu chaalu.

30.8 He looks at their joined hands. For a long moment, we think he might.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: joined hands, lightning-lit. CU Vikram, 85mm; hold.

VIKRAM

Ten thousand.

Padi velu.

RANI

I'll manage.

Sardukuntaa.

VIKRAM

Sravya's last semester is sixty-two. Her placement suits and travel, fifteen. Kiran has two more years: two lakh eighty, minimum, if he doesn't fail anything. Ammamma's follow-up physiotherapy, eight thousand a month. Your room rent if you leave here — Gachibowli, cheapest, nine thousand. Food. Bus. Phone. You want to do this on ten?

Sravya last semester aravai rendu velu. Placement battalu, prayaanam, padihenu. Kiranki inkaa rendellu: kaneesam rendu lakshala enabhai, okka subject koodaa fail avvakapote. Ammamma physiotherapy, nelaki enimidi velu. Ikkadnunchi velte room rent — gacchibaulilo ati takkuva, tommidi velu. Tindi. Bassu. Phone. Idantaa padi velatonaa?

RANI

People do it!

Janam chestunnaarugaa!

VIKRAM

People's children drop out! Their grandmothers stop physio! You told me Kiran wants to do an MS in America. On ten thousand? Who's paying, his father?

Janam pillalu chaduvu maanestunnaaru! Vaalla Ammammalu physio aapestunnaaru! Kiran Americalo enes cheyaalanukuntunnaadani nuvve cheppaav. Padi velatonaa? Evaru kadataaru, vaadi naannaa?

30.9 That lands like a slap. She lets go of his hands.

CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her hands letting go.

VIKRAM

I'm not saying it to hurt you. I'm saying it because nobody else will say it to you straight. This city pays a woman with ninth class ten thousand rupees for twelve hours of standing. It pays you forty for one night. That's not my rule. I just know the rule.

Ninnu baadhapettadaaniki cheppatledu. Inkevvaroo neeku sootigaa chepparu kaabatti cheptunnaa. Tommido taragati chadivina aadadaaniki ee ooruu pannendu gantalu nilabadite padi velu istundi. Neeku okka raatriki nalabhai istundi. Adi naa rule kaadu. Aa rule naaku telusu ante.

RANI

You made me into the rule!

Nanne aa rulegaa maarchaav!

VIKRAM

I showed you the rule!

Neeku aa rule choopinchaa ante!

30.10 They are both on their feet now. Thunder. Lightning shows their faces in flashes.

CAMERA Handheld two-shot, 35mm, standing face to face; lightning strobes in rhythm with the lines.

RANI

You knew from the first day! From the bus station! You looked at my trunk and said "you brought the whole house" and you were already counting! Every pillow that came off that bed was a step in your book!

Modati roju nunche neeku telusu! Bus station nunche! Naa trunk pette choosi "Illu mottam teccheshaaraa" annaav, appude lekkalu modalupettaav! Aa bed meeda nunchi poyina prati dindoo nee pustakanlo oka step!

VIKRAM

And did you hate those steps? Tell me. Tell me the truth. The terrace. The jeans. The cake. The nights. Did you hate any of it?

Aa steps neeku nacchaledaa? Cheppu. Nijam cheppu. Terrace. Jeans. Cake. Aa raatrullu. Vaatilo edainaa neeku asahyangaa anipinchindaa?

30.11 She can't answer. That is the knife.

CAMERA Locked-off CU Rani, 85mm; 5 seconds of silence and rain.

VIKRAM

I gave you thirty-five years in two months. Nobody else ever gave you even one day. Your father gave you to a man. Your husband gave you to his mother. Your mother-in-law gave you to the kitchen. I'm the only one who ever gave you to yourself.

Rendu nelallo neeku muppai aidellu icchaa. Inkevvaroo neeku okka roju koodaa ivvaledu. Mee naanna ninnu oka magaadiki icchaadu. Nee bharta ninnu vaallammaki icchaadu. Mee atta ninnu vantintiki icchindi. Ninnu neeke icchindi nenokkadine.

RANI

And then you sold me.

Aa tarvaata nannu ammeshaav.

30.12 Silence. Long. The rain.

CAMERA Wide two-shot, 24mm; hold 6 seconds.

VIKRAM *(quietly)*

And then I sold you.

Aa tarvaata ninnu ammeshaa.

30.13 He sits down, suddenly tired. For the first time in the film he looks his age — twenty-five, young, and lost in his own trade.

CAMERA MS Vikram on the couch, 50mm, slight high angle, making him small.

VIKRAM

You think I wanted to be this? My mother sweeps your Ammamma's courtyard for three hundred a week. I came to this city with eight hundred rupees, that part was true. The first event I "managed" was carrying chairs. The second was carrying a drunk girl to a car for a man who gave me five thousand. That's how it starts. Nobody plans it. You just find out what you're worth to people, and it's always more than the honest price.

Nenu ilaa avvaalanukunnaanaa? Maa Amma vaaraaniki moodondalaki mee Ammamma vaakili oodustundi. Enimidi vandalato ee ooriki vacchaa, adi nijame. Nenu "Menej" chesina modati event kurcheelu moyadam. Rendodi, aidu velu icchina okadi kosam taagi unna oka Ammaayini caru daakaa moyadam. Alaage modalavutundi. Evaroo plaan cheyaru. Janaaniki nuvvu enta viluvo telustundi, adi eppudoo nijaayitee dhara kante ekkuve untundi.

RANI

Then stop.

Ayite aaapey.

VIKRAM

Then what? I go back to chairs? You go back to ten thousand? And we live here in love like a film song while Sravya sells her chain to pay fees?

Tarvaata? Nenu mallee kurcheelu moyaalaa? Nuvvu padi velaki vellaalaa? Fees kosam Sravya golu ammu kunte manam ikkada sinimaa paatalaa preminchukuntloo batakalaa?

30.14 She has no answer. Neither does he. They sit — she on the floor, he on the couch — a metre apart, the same distance as the first night of the rain. The lights do not come back on this time.

CAMERA Wide, 24mm, matching Scene 8's couch frame exactly; lightning only.

RANI (*whispering*)

I can't leave you.

Ninnu vadili vellalenu.

VIKRAM

I know.

Telusu.

RANI

That's the worst part. Not the men. Not the money. That I can't leave you. When I come home from them, I come home to you, and you dry my hair, and I'm grateful. I'm grateful to the man who sent me. What kind of woman is that?

Ade annitikante ghoram. Aa magaallu kaadu. Dabbu kaadu. Ninnu vadalalekapovadam. Vaalla daggarnunchi intikoste, nee daggarike vastaa, nuvvu naa juttu tudustaav, naaku krutajnata kalugutundi. Nannu pampinavaadi meede krutajnata. Alaanti aadadi elaantidi?

VIKRAM

A tired one.

Alasipoyinadi.

RANI

An addicted one. You're my cigarette. I know it's killing me and my hand still reaches.

Alavaataipoyinadi. Nuvvu naa cigarettevi. Champutondani telusu, ayinaa cheyi daani vaipe veltundi.

30.15 He slides down from the couch to the floor beside her. Not touching. Their shoulders almost touching. The same picture as Scene 8, mirrored. CAMERA Floor-level two-shot, 50mm, mirrored composition of Scene 8 (flip sides).	VIKRAM Do you want me to promise? <i>Promise cheyamantaavaa?</i> RANI Promise what? <i>Emani?</i> VIKRAM Anything. Good customers. A real job. Marriage. Whatever you want to hear tonight. <i>Edainaa. Manchi customerlu. Nijamaina udyogam. Pelli. Ee raatri nuvvem vinaalanukunte adi.</i> RANI Would it be true? <i>Adi nijamavutundaa?</i>
30.16 A very long beat. CAMERA CU Vikram, 85mm; hold 8 seconds.	VIKRAM I don't know anymore. <i>Ippudu naake teliyatledu.</i>
30.17 That is the most honest thing he has said in the film. She puts her head on his shoulder. He puts his arm around her. They sit in the dark, in the storm, holding each other, neither of them asleep. CAMERA Slow pull-back to a wide, 24mm; lightning flashes reveal them, then darkness.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Exact echo of Scene 8: same storm design, same lightning cues, same couch position — but no candles; the laptop is the only light until it closes, then lightning only. Rani stays wet for the whole scene: warm-water rig, wardrobe doubles of R18, heater and robe between takes. Long takes for the fight; two cameras. The power does not come back on.

SCENE 31 INT. PENTHOUSE — HALL CUM KITCHEN — BEFORE DAWN

NEW · ROMANCE

Scene No.	31 (new romance scene)	INT / EXT	INT
Location	Penthouse — stove and counter	Story day, date & time	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 04:30
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree (she has changed into her arrival saree) VIKRAM — Costume V13: grey vest and track pants, crumpled from a night on the floor		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Kadai with tadka (mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic), steel plate of upma, steel tumbler and dabara of filter coffee, spoons, counter stool		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
31.1 The Last Upma. 4:30 a.m. The storm has passed; the power is back. Rani stands at the stove. Mustard seeds, curry leaves, garlic: the same tadka as Scene 4. Vikram wakes on the floor where they sat all night, smells it, and comes to the counter. She sets a steel plate of upma and a tumbler of filter coffee in front of him, exactly as on the first morning. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: mustard seeds popping (match Scene 4). MCU Vikram waking on the floor, 50mm. Same counter two-shot as Scene 4, 35mm.	VIKRAM Upma. <i>Upmaa.</i> RANI The first morning. You closed your eyes on the first spoon. I saw. <i>Modati podduna. Modati muddake kallu moosukunnaav. Nenu chooshaa.</i>
31.2 They eat in silence, standing at the counter, shoulders touching. Long, real-time: only spoons on steel and the city waking. CAMERA Profile two-shot at the counter, 50mm, locked off; 60–90 seconds of real time.	VIKRAM Why now? <i>Ippudenduku?</i> RANI Because I wanted to cook for you once more without counting anything. <i>E lekkaloo lekundaa neeku inkosaari vandi pettaalanipinchindi.</i>
31.3 He puts the spoon down. He understands something and doesn't say it. CAMERA Insert, 50mm: spoon set down on the plate (echo of Scene 4). CU Vikram, 85mm.	—

31.4 She hums the Ghantasala tune softly. He takes her hand and draws her away from the stove. They dance in the narrow kitchen with no music but her humming, slow, barely moving, her head under his chin. CAMERA Slow arc around the two of them, 35mm on slider; humming only.	VIKRAM <i>(whispering)</i> Stay. <i>Undipo.</i>
31.5 She doesn't answer. She keeps humming. CAMERA CU Rani, eyes closed against his chest, 85mm.	VIKRAM Stay. I'll — I'll figure something out. <i>Undipo. Nenu — edokati chestaa.</i>
31.6 She stops humming and looks up at him. CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm.	RANI Ask me. <i>Adugu.</i> VIKRAM What? <i>Enti?</i> RANI You promised. On the terrace. Every time. Ask me. <i>Promise cheshaav. Terrace meeda. Pratisaaree ani. Adugu.</i>
31.7 A long beat. His eyes fill. It is the first time we have seen him cry. CAMERA ECU Vikram's eyes, 100mm.	VIKRAM Are you okay, Rani? <i>Nuvvu baagunnaavaa Ranee?</i>
31.8 She looks at him for a long time. She touches his wet cheek with her thumb, the way she wiped the mud from his face in Scene 5. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her thumb on his wet cheek (match Scene 5's pallu wipe).	RANI Mango thief. <i>Maamidikaayala donga.</i>
31.9 She doesn't answer the question. She rests her head on his chest, and they keep dancing. Behind them, the window greys toward dawn. CAMERA Wide, 24mm, window behind them shifting from black to grey; hold.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Exact recreation of Scene 4's tadka and plate — same plate, tumbler and stool position; storm has passed, power back. Vikram's tears must be genuine or very well supported (no glycerine close-ups). Keep the dance slow, almost still; humming live, no score until the final hold.

SCENE 32 EXT. PENTHOUSE TERRACE — DAWN

Scene No.	32	INT / EXT	EXT
Location	Penthouse terrace — rail, water tank, terrace door and stairwell door	Story day, date & time	Day 119 · Sun 5 October · 06:00 (sunrise)
Actors & costume	RANI — Costume R1: turmeric-yellow cotton saree (exact arrival look) VIKRAM — Costume V13: grey vest and track pants, crumpled		
Screen duration (approx.)	~6 min	Movement	5 — The Dilemma
Props & furniture	Rani's steel trunk (packed), wet terrace (sprayed), dead fairy lights over the water tank with one broken bulb, jasmine pot with fallen flowers, Rani's phone (voice-note waveform graphic), Vikram's second phone (booking preview graphic), terrace door, stairwell door		

ACTION · CAMERA ANGLE & LENS	DIALOGUE · English / Telugu (Roman script)
32.1 The storm has passed. The terrace is wet and glittering. The city below washed clean. The fairy lights from Club Penthouse and the wedding still hang over the water tank, dead, one bulb broken. The jasmine has dropped its flowers in the rain. CAMERA Wide establishing, 24mm, sunrise; insert, 100mm: broken bulb; insert: fallen jasmine flowers on wet floor.	—
32.2 Rani stands at the rail in the turmeric cotton saree from Scene 1. Her steel trunk is beside her — packed. We don't know when she packed it. Vikram comes out, sees the trunk, stops. CAMERA MS Rani at the rail, 50mm, trunk in frame (match the platform composition of Scene 1). Reverse MS Vikram in the doorway.	—
32.3 They look at each other. No words. CAMERA Matched CUs, 85mm; hold.	—

32.4 Her phone buzzes. A voice note from Sravya. She plays it on speaker. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: voice-note waveform on screen. CU Rani listening, 85mm.	SRAVYA (<i>V.O., voice note</i>) Amma! Amma, I got it! Campus placement! A big audit firm, here in Hyderabad! Four point two lakhs a year! Joining in June! I'll be in your city, Amma! We can live together! You can quit, you can rest, I'll take care of everything now! I couldn't wait to tell you. Call me when you wake up. Love you, Amma. Love you, love you, love you! <i>Ammaa! Ammaa, vacchesindi! Kyaampas placement! Hyderabadlone oka pedda aadit kampenee! Edaadiki naalugu lakshala iravai velu! Joonlo jaayining! Nee oorlone untaa Ammaa! Manam kalisi undocchu! Nuvvu udyogam maaneyocchu, rest teesukovacchu, ika annee nenu choosukuntaa! Neeku cheppakundaa aagalekapoyaa. Levagaane phone chey. Love you Ammaa. Love you, love you, love you!</i>
32.5 The voice note ends. Rani's hand goes over her mouth. Tears stream down. She laughs — a pure, unbroken laugh, the one from the first morning. CAMERA CU Rani, 85mm; hold through the laugh (match the Scene 2 hand-to-mouth).	—
32.6 Then the arithmetic arrives on her face. June. Eight months away. Joining salary. Kiran's two years. Ammamma's physio. The rent. The math Vikram taught her. And her daughter coming to live in this city — the city where she is known in room 412. CAMERA Same CU, no cut; the expression changes within the shot.	—
32.7 She looks down at her open palm. The ink house from Scene 22 washed away weeks ago; only a faint blue smudge remains in one crease. CAMERA Insert, 100mm macro: open palm, faint blue smudge in a crease.	—
32.8 Vikram's second phone vibrates in his pocket. He takes it out. Looks at it. A booking. We see only the preview: "Tonight 9pm. Regular. Asked for R specifically. 50." CAMERA Insert, 100mm: booking preview on the second phone (screen graphic).	—

32.9 He looks up at Rani. She saw it. She looks at the phone. At him. At the trunk. At the city. At her own phone with her daughter's voice still on the screen. CAMERA Sequence of eye-line cuts, 85mm: her look to each object in turn.	VIKRAM <i>(barely audible)</i> I can say no to him. <i>Vaadiki nenu vaddani cheppagalanu.</i> RANI Can you? <i>Cheppagalavaa?</i>
32.10 He doesn't answer. She picks up the trunk handle. Holds it. The same grip as the platform in Scene 1. CAMERA Insert, 100mm: her grip on the trunk handle (exact match of Scene 1's bag-handle insert).	—
32.11 She looks at the open terrace door: behind it, the bedroom, the bed, the man. She looks at the stairwell door: behind it, the city, the bus, the village, her children, a life of ten thousand rupees and a clean conscience. CAMERA Her POV: terrace door into the flat, 35mm; her POV: stairwell door, 35mm. Back to MS Rani between them.	—
32.12 Vikram's phone vibrates again in his hand. Unanswered. The camera slowly pushes in on Rani's face. She doesn't move. Her knuckles whiten on the trunk handle. The phone keeps vibrating. Her daughter's voice-note waveform glows on her screen. CAMERA One continuous dolly push-in from MS to ECU, 50mm → 85mm equivalent, about 60 seconds. Vibration sound continuous.	—
32.13 Hold. Hold. Hold. She opens her mouth to speak — CUT TO BLACK. CAMERA Hard cut to black on the first parting of her lips.	—
32.14 In the silence, one last sound: the steel trunk being set down — or lifted. We cannot tell which. CAMERA Black frame; single designed sound.	—
32.15 END TITLE CARD (white on black): "Most women trafficked into sex work are not taken by strangers. They are invited in by someone they trust." A helpline number appears beneath it. Use a current, verified national helpline at the time of release. ROLL CREDITS over the sound of Hyderabad waking up. CAMERA Title card graphics; credits over city ambience.	—

SHOOT INSTRUCTIONS

Shoot at true sunrise; wet down the terrace for the post-storm glitter. The final push-in on Rani is one continuous dolly move, about 60 seconds; the cut to black lands on her opening her mouth. The final sound (trunk set down or lifted) is designed ambiguously in post. End title card text and helpline must be verified before release. Sravya's employer stays generic ("a big audit firm") — no real company names.